

Utility Billing User Guide

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Overview

This section of the guide is an overview of how the utility billing system works. Read this section first to get a picture of what the software can do for your town or agency.

The remaining sections of the guide describe the purpose and operating instructions for each program. The sections of the guide are arranged in the same order as they appear on the computer menus. They are grouped together in the order you will use them, the most often used first, followed by the programs you will use infrequently. Read these sections once now, then refer to them later or when you have a specific question about how a program operates.

The appendices in this guide describe how to navigate the menus, scan tables, and how to pop up view help on line.

What the System Can Do for You

The utility billing system will help you produce utility bills and collect taxes accurately and quickly. It will help you handle bills less and spend less time posting and tallying.

Your computer or work station can help you service taxpayer who arrive at your counter to pay taxes. The computer will post the payments and print a receipt, taking care of a taxpayer while they are in your office. If you have our tax collection system you can collect town taxes and utility tax from the same menu and control their collection with one together.

Usage or Assessment Billing

Manage the assessment of property owners for initial hookup to a sewer system, and control the billing and collection over any number of years including the calculation of bond interest. Bill for periodic water or sewer usage on any schedule you desire. The system handles annual quarterly, monthly weekly or any other billing schedule you design. Set fees base on a flat fee, minimum, or six units you can define such as CCF of employees.

In this guide we call a taxpayer at a particular location a Hookup. We refer to any charge that is periodic, annual for example, which is billed for use, as a Use Bill. Charges levied once and then payed off over a period of years using a bond, we call an Assessment Bill.

Mirror Your Town's Physical Layout

Hookups contain all of the information defining who is billed and how they are billed. It contains the taxpayers name, address, property location and description and the number of units they are billed. The units can be gallons or CCF's of use or a fixed unit such as number of bathrooms.

Divide your hookups into as many groups as you need to manage your town. We call groups these Rate Groups.

A rate group defines the fees for a group of hookups. It determines how much you will charge a hookup for the units

they use or have. You may define rate group for the entire town or define several rate group for several sections of town or class of hookups. Each hookup in a rate group can have up to six rate components chosen from an set of fees you defined for the rate group. There is no limit on the number of hookups, rate groups, fees and billing schedules you can create.

Bill on Any Schedule

Each rate group can have a different billing schedule. Create usage or assessment bills from the hookups by asking the computer to create bills for a particular rate group you defined. The computer will use the units show on he hookup and the rates in the rate group to create a new usage bill or to create the next installment of an assessment bill.

After the bills are created you print bill to send taxpayers and perhaps a rate book and cross reference to support the collection effort in you office.

Collect On The Counter

Most of your days are filled with receiving tax payments, responding to question about account and balances and making changes to the list you are collecting.

The posting program is designed to bring up all of a taxpayers bills when they enter the office. You can locate a taxpayers by taxpayers name, property location, map, meter, route or list number of one of their bills. The computer shows you taxes due along with current interest. When you accept a payment, the computer automatically allocates the money to all the outstanding bills, and prints a receipt to hand the taxpayer.

The posting program also serves as an easy way to view an account balance and print a statement for an account. You can use it to give a taxpayer a statement of what they owe or answer a telephone inquiry.

Control Cash

The computer not only updates the tax bill it maintains a complete record of the cash transaction. You can use up to 22 work stations to post at the same time, and the computer keeps track of the cash and checks by batch, clerk, and cash draw. You can recap your posting by a batch, day, week, month, or any period and see how it affects all of your groups.

At the end of collection day balance your collections to the actual cash, make a deposit, and run reports for the treasurer. All information changed during the workday is immediately reflected in the account balances.

Periodic Reports

You can pursue unpaid hookups by creating and mailing delinquent bill and/or statements. Print rate books through-out the year, as you need them to help you control your collections. and then a final copy at the end of the year to have bound.

Cross reference lists will provide walk in traffic as well

as other folks in you town and agency with a compact reference to the location of hookups.

You Are Well Connected

The utility billing software offers you the same look and feel of our outstanding tax collection software. If you have our tax collection system you can access and post to usage bills from the same menu as your property tax bills.

In addition if your tax assessor has our tax assessment software you can run your system linked to your assessors names and address.

We can suck in usage data from the Greater Hartford MDC, your local water company or your own scan guns making loading usage information a snap.

File Maintenance

Just as you periodically would take the time to straighten up your manual files, the computer's data files need looking after from time to time also.

The computer finds the data on the disk by using an index. It is much like an index in a book which lets you find a particular chapter quickly. As you make payments and change data the computer's data files become messy and the index becomes disorganized. This makes computer work harder (slower). Condensing your data data files puts them files back into shape.

Verifying the files periodically proves to you and us that all the data in the computer is still in balance and readable. We will advise you on what file maintenance schedule is best for your town.

Backup, Backup, Backup!

The only place your tax data resides is in the computer in your office. You must take great care to prevent its loss.

Fire, a leaky roof, theft of the computer, or vandalism can cause loss of your computer and the data in it.

Making a duplicate copy of all of the data in your computer storing it in a safe (fire proof) place on a regular schedule is essential. We will advise you on a method and time table which suits your town and office.

How to Stop A Program

From time to time you will want to stop a report or a program you started by mistake. The quickest (and safest) way to stop a program and return to the menu is to push the Esc key. Any other procedure you use to stop a program is not recommended.

Batch Control

Use this program to open, close and balance batches.

Payment Batches

Payments you post to the utility billing system are grouped in batches. Batches help you control the posting process and balance the dollars you collect against the postings. This program will let you open, balance and close payment batches.

Each clerk can open and close batches to control their work independently of other clerks. The two letter clerk ID is shown at the top of the display.

How to Open a Batch

To post payments you have to open a batch to put them in. Pick Batch, Open and the computer will display:

The computer will make up a batch date using today's date. If you wish to open this batch pick OK, otherwise pick Cancel and the computer will ask

Batch ID 990101A
Fiscal MO 990101A

The computer will make up a batch date using today's date. If you wish to open this batch pick OK, otherwise specify the Batch and Fiscal Month you wish to use.

The Batch Id is the date tax payments are collected in the format YYMMDDX where YY is the year, MM the month, DD the day, and X the sequence.

Your Fiscal Month interest date can be earlier than the batch date. This is helpful when you have to wait a few days before posting the payment you receive via mail.

How to Print a Batch

Pick Print to print a paper report of the batch. The computer will ask:

Pick Kind

Usage
Assessment
Both

Format

Full
Totals Only

Pick the kind of transactions you would like to see on the report and the format of the report.
totals.

How to Close A Batch

After you have posted payments for a period of time, you will want to check the totals of the batch and close it. How long you leave a batch open is up to you. It is best to close batches so that they match your balancing periods.

Pick Batch, Close to close the open batch. Then Respond OK to

Close batch 991001X?

Move a Batch

You may have the need to re-date the batch. That is, you may have inadvertently posted to 120405A (April) when you intend to post to 120504A (May). Pick Batch, Move and the computer will ask for the password PROOF.

From
To

Specify as from the batch date you used, and as to the batch date you want.

Frequently Asked Questions

How do I print a batch I close yesterday?

Use the Treasurer's Report and specify the date of the batch you wish to print.

Post Payments

Use this program to post payments, to locate account balances and to print bills and statements.

The computer will present all outstanding bills for an account and apply payments against them correctly, with interest updated automatically. You can also use this program to void payments made in error and to apply credits and refunds.

How to Post Payments

If you have used our tax collection system for collecting property taxes this program will look very familiar to you. It operates in a similar manner and uses similar actions. The rules it uses to compute interest and apply payments, however, are different.

Start by using the Record Locator, the VCR buttons, or the actions on the View Menu to locate a hookup. See the Update Hookups section of this guide for examples of how to find hookups.

The computer will show you all of the bills for this account. The computer will total the pay-up and pay-off amounts due on all of the bills shown and display the total on the bottom of the display. The computer will show you delinquent interest computed through the batch data show at the top of display.

To see just one bill for payment double click on the bill and pick Pick from the pop up menu.

Making the Payment

Push the Tab to move to the Payment item. If you see no Payment item on the display, you do not have a batch open.

Payment

Type the amount you want to pay. Do not key in the decimal point. If you push Tab without typing an amount the computer will assume you are paying the full amount due. The following items are optional so anytime you are done and wish to make the payment push the F3 key or click the green check.

Cash
KCheck
Bankcard

Pick the form of the payment.

Tendered

Type the amount you are receiving. If you push the Tab key the computer will assume you are receiving the same amount you are paying.

If your payment does not match the balance outstanding on the account the computer will ask:

You are not paying the amount due.

Click Ok to acknowledge the partial payment.

he computer will apply the payment against the bills shown on the display. The payment is applied differently for usage and assessment bills. Usage bill are paid oldest first in all categories, Assessment bill are paid in each of the following categories oldest to newest, Bond, Interest, Fee and Lien.

Limiting the Bills You See

Pick Kind and then the type of bill you wish to see on the display. Pick Kind, Hide Zero to have the computer only show you bills with balances.

Paying More Than Is Due

If the amount you are posting exceed the amount due for the bills the computer will post the excess on the tax amount on the most recent bill.

If the account is a assessment account the outstanding assessment balance will be reduces by the excess.

How Make a Final or Advance Payment

Full Final Posting With Outstanding Bills

Pay an assessment account and specify the exact PayOff figure, the computer will warn you that you are making a final payment, pay all outstanding bills and create a final bill/payment for the remaining tax, bond, and lien fee. The posting of the total happen in one swoop and the assessment is paid in full.

Partial Final Payments With Outstanding Bills

Pay an assessment account and specify the an amount greater than PayUp and not equal to the payoff figure, the computer will warn you that you are making a payment against the assessment, and then post the excess amount against the tax and bond interest. The computer will compute the bond interest as the bond rate times the months since the last bill times the amount of excess payment not paying bond interest.

Printing a Receipt

Where the computer prints receipts, bills and statements depend on how you ask it. If you pick from the Statement menu the computer will give you the option to print on any printer defined to your work station. If you pick form the Receipt menu the computer will print the the Receipting printer attached to the PC's Lpt1 port.

The Update, Options, Posting tab contain a check box

☐ User Receipt Printer

If this box is checked the Receipt menu selection will appear in the posting program..

After you have payed and account the computer will optionally print a receipt for the taxpayer. You can set your preference in Update Option on the Posting Tab. You can change the options for the session by picking File, Option in the posting program.

You can ask the computer to print a receipt by using the Statement, Receipt action.

If you place your town seal in ser-logo.jpg, sized 100 x 100, it will print on the receipt.

Voiding Payment Made in a Specific Batch

Find the hookup you wish to work on. If you wish to void all of the payments make on a specific batch date pick Pay, Void from the menu. The computer will ask

Do you want to void a payment made on specific date to the bills disp

Push the Yes button and the computer will ask

Batch Date

Specify the batch date of the payment. The computer will find the payment you made on the date to the hookup and ask you to click ok to confirm the deletion.

If the payment you are voiding contain a assessment advanced or final payment the comptuer will ask:

You made a final payment on this batch date.
I will remove the final bill too.

Click Ok to remove the final bill and attach its voided payments to the most recent installment. Click Cancel to leave the final bill, (and its voided payments in place.

Voiding A Specific Payment

If you wish to void a specific single payment against a particular bill, double click on the bill, pick Void from the pop up menu. The computer will show you the payments you made on the bill, double click on the one you wish to void. The computer will ask to specify that the transaction was Cash, Check, NoCash by picking from a pop up menu.

If you pick a Final Assessment bill, the computer will ask

Void all payments attached to this bill and reverse the effects of the advance payment?

If you click Ok the computer will remove the Final bill that was created to hold the final payment, void the final payment and place attach the void again the newest regular bill.

Double click on the payments you wish to void. The computer will pop up menu:

Cash
Check
Bank Card
No Cash
FM Shift

If this transaction is affecting your cash draw, pick the same form of payment you used when you originally posted the payment. If the void in not affecting your cash draw pick 'No Cash'.

Is this a Bad Check you will not repost today.
Click Yes and I will segregate this void as a bad check void.

If you are voiding a check to be able to repay the same amounts just to reallocating the payment categories respond Cancel. If you are voiding a bad check, not to be reposed today and you do not want this void to affect your collections respond Ok. Responding Ok will cause this void to be segregated in a manner similar to refunds and write offs.

If you told the computer to print receipts, a VOID receipt will print.

How to Manually Allocate a Payment

If you pay an account using the Pay action, the computer will decide how much of the payment goes towards the tax, interest, and the other charge categories. If you wish you can override this automatic allocation and decide for yourself how much goes towards each category.

After Finding the account pick the bill you wish to pay by double clicking on it. Then pick Pay, Manual form the menu to apply the amount you receive against a specific charge categories.

Reason
Tax
Other
Bond
Delq

Type the amount you wish to pay under each charge category. Use the reason for any tow character code you wish to help you later identify why you choose to override the standard posting scheme.

Click OK to apply the payment.

Writeoffs

The Writeoff action work just like the Manual action except the amount you pay are marked as a write off.

If you pick write off for an assessment hookup that has no bills due (no payup) the computer will ask you if you wish to write off some or all of the remaining assessment.

How to Refund

Use the Refund and the computer will let you tell it how much to add back to each charge category.

First, Find the account you with to work on, and pick the specific bill you are refunding. Then pick the Pay, Refund action form the menu. The computer will ask you for the amounts

Reason
Tax
Other
Bond
Delq

Type the amounts you wish to refund under each charge category. The computer will total the amounts as you type them and show you the amount you are refunding.

The computer will then ask for the amount tendered and the type of monies tendered just as it does when you use the Pay action to normally pay an account.

Quick Post

If you have a batch of check which arrived it the mail and they all exactly pay a current bill you can use the Pay, QuickKey action to rapidly post the bill.

Pick the Pay, QuickKey action and the record locator will change to Quick Key. Each Hookup you type will have the current bill payed in full.

The computer will not post to the hookup if:

1. The tax due is zero.
2. There is delinquent interest or Other Fees due.
3. There are back taxes due.
4. There is both Usage and Assessment bill due.

If you make a mistake, return to the standard posting mode and void the payment.

You can end Quick Key by Pushing the Record locator button or the F4 Order function key.

Pick Pay, Quick Gun to shoot the bar codes instead of typing the list numbers.

How to Post an Agency File

If you have a bank collecting payments for you or a tax service bureau sending you escrow payments you can use the Get menu to suck in and apply payment from a data file they send you.

Pick Pay on the menu and then Get Payment File.

Post File Name

If you received the file via email save to you working folder. (Our frequently asked questions at www.aldenovakdodd.com/faq has instruction on how to locate your working folder.)

Type the name of the file the agency sent. They will likely note the file name in documentation they send you. Type the name of the file you saved above. For example to read a file called MYBANK.DAT you would type

A:MYNAME.DAT

If the file has no extension type the name followed by a period

A:MYNAME.

Posting Options

Skip if Not Exact
Force All Payments

Pick Skip if not exact to have the computer not post any payment which does not exactly match the amount due. Pick Force All Payments to have the computer post the amount the agency is reporting.

The computer will post the payments in the batch you have open just as if you posted them yourself individually.

Print Options

Tell the computer what you want it to print. Remember you can get a full accounting of the payments by print the batch or treasurer's report as you would for any other batch.

The exceptions it will print are payments not posted because:

1. The Tax Due is zero or less
2. The Account is not on file.
3. The amount paid is not equal to the balance.

The computer can read a file for a bank lock box, or form another parry, of the file contains the hookup and payment amount somewhere in the first 50 characters.

The computer will examine the file you specified to determine if it is a flat ASCII file or a Comma Separated Value File (CSV).

Posting a Flat Agency File

If the computer recognizes the file as a bank lock box it will ask

This file appears to be from a bank on 01/01/2012.
Post it?

If you have a file form another agency the computer will ask you to tell it where the list number STARTS and the payment amount ENDS.

Here is an example of a file formats the computer can read:

Hookup	6
Amount	10

For this file you would specify

Hookup START in column 1
Payment END in column 16

111111	999888	SMITH	ROGER	P
1234567890	1234567890	1234567890	1234567890	
1	2	3	4	

After you specify the columns and click ok the computer will ask you to confirm your specification

Using the columns specified I will pay hookup 111111 with \$99.88

Click ok to proceed.

Posting a CSV Agency File

The computer will ask

This file appears to be a comma separated value file.
Process it as a lock box file?

Click Cancel and the computer will process the file as a Flat ASCII file (see above). Click Ok and the computer will ask

YrList is in item 1
Payment is in item 12

1	2004111111
2	1
3	F

4
5
... 12 41.12

Look at the items shown in the list and confirm the location of the Year-List and Payment amount by specifying the item numbers where they appear.

Click Ok to proceed.

How to Print a Statement

Pick Statement, Statement or and the computer will print a statement for the bills shown on the display.

How to Change the Interest Date

The computer will show you delinquent interested for all bill you get, computer through the batch date shown above the Payment items. You can change the interest date by using File, Fiscal Month menu selection or by pushing the FM button

Interest date

Type the date you want the computer to use to calculate delinquent interest. The date you set will hold until you reset it.

Running Totals

The computer keeps a running total of the items you posted. The two totals are:

Transaction Balance
Transaction Paid

Each time an account is brought up to view the computer adds the balance due to the Transaction Balance total. Each time a payment is posted with a P action the balance is added to the Transaction Paid total.

Pick File, Total to see these running totals. Pick Clear to clear the totals to zero.

How the Computer Records the Payments

The computer marks each payment you post with the action you used to post it. So a payment posted using Pay, Pay is marked PP, Payment Posted. A payment you create as a result of a Pay, Void is marked PV, Payment Void. Here is a table you can refer to:

Code	How Posted
PP	Post
PV	Void
PR	Refund
PM	Manual
PO	Overpayment
PF	Final

The computer can handle a maximum of ninety nine (99) payments per bill. Each void, correction, payment, and refund is counted.

Bill/Payment Report

Use this program to print payments. Use the options to select by batch, hookup, or type of payment to help you print and review payment transaction such as write offs, voids or regular payments.

Report Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask

Pick Type

Every Type
Water
Sewer
A Assmt
B Assmt

Pick the type of payment you wish to print.

Order

Batch Order
Hookup Order
Date of Bill

Pick the order you wish to see.

Kind

All Kinds
Manuals
Payments
Refunds
Transfer CR
Voids
Write offs

Pick the kind of payment you wish to see.

Payment Of

Anything
Lien/Other
Bond Interest
Delq Interest

You may pick payments for presentation on the report which have a particular type of charge paid. For example, to only pick payment which had a payment against Lien/Other pick Lien/Other here.

If you wish to limit the batches printed on the report check the Pick by Batch box and specify the batch number range.

Pick by Batch

☒ Pick by Batch?
Start 021201A
End 021231Z

The above selection will print payment entered in batch during December 2002.

If you wish to limit the hookup printed on the report check this box and specify the hookup number range.

Pick by Hookup

☒ Pick by Hookup?
Start 900001
End 900100

The above selection will print hookups 900001 to 900100.

If you wish to limit the report to payment against specific billings this box and specify the bill date range

Pick by Billings

☒ Pick by Bill?
From 11/01/2001
To 11/01/2001

The above selection will only print transactions that hit a 11/02/2001 bill.

☐ Print Totals Only

If you wish to see totals only, check this box.

☐ Print ratepayer's name?
☐ Print map?
☐ Print account?

If you wish to see the ratepayer's name, map or account printed on the associated check box.

Bill/Payment Search

Use this program to find a bill or payment you misplaced.
This program will locate all payment with attributes you
specify such as a particular tax amount.

How Locate a Transaction

Select the program on the menu and the computer will display

What Kind

Sewer
Water
Assessment

Pick the kind of transactions you wish to search.

Transaction Types

Payments
Bills
Credits
All

Pick the kind of transaction you want to locate.

- ☐ Look for Bill Date of 01/01/2005
- ☐ Look for Payment Date of 01/01/2005

Check the box and specify a date to search for.

Look for Amounts

Installment of
Lien/Other of
Bond Interest of
Delinquent Interest of

Type the amount in each category you want the computer to
locate. Leave an amount zero to have the computer not use
the number in its search. For example to locate \$170
installment amounts type 170.00 in "Installment of"
and leave the other three zero.

Treasurer's Report

Use this program to print a summary of payments posted.

Report Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you:

Format

Full
Abbreviated
Totals Only

Pick Full to print the payments, batch totals and final summary totals, pick Abbreviated to print the batch total and summary totals or pick Totals Only to print the final summary total only,

Type

1 All Usage
2 All Assmt
Every Type
Water Use
Sewer Use
A Assessment
B Assessment

Pick the type of bill you wish to print in the book.

Pick Batches

☐ Pick By Batch?
From
To

Check this box and specify the batches you wish to print.
For example to print all payment posted using October 1998:

Pick Batches

☐ Pick By Batch?
From 981001A
To 981001Z

Pick Payment Kind

1 All Payments
Finals Only

...

Specify the kind of payment you wish to include on the report.

☐ Print the Name with each payment?

Check this box to print the name in a Full format book on each payment.

☐ Print the account with each payment?

Check this box to print the account in a Full format book on each payment.

☐ Print a subtotal by hookup?

Check this box to print a total of the amount paid against a hookup, that is the amount of the check or cash applied in the transaction.

☐ Print Final Total Table by

1 Bill Date/Payment Kind
2 Group/Payment Kind/Bill Date

3 Group/Assessment Date

If you want the payments totaled in a final table, check this checkbox
pick the order of final total table printed on the report.

Annual Summary

Use this program to print a report that summarizes activity, bills issues and payments received, by fiscal year or calendar year.

Report Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask

Pick Type

Every Type
Water Use
Sewer Use
A Assessment
B Assessment

Specify the type of hookup you wish to print.

Sum By

Fiscal Year
Calendar Year

Specify the kind of period you wish to use.

Thru Year

Year 2004

Specify the new year you wish to recap. For example if you use 2004 as show above with Fiscal Year the report will start with the balances for the fiscal year 07/10/2003 to 06/30/2004 and show 30 earlier years.

Hookups

Use this program to maintain your list of accounts. You can use it to add new hookup or to change a hookup already on file.

How to Locate An Account

Use the record locator to find an account. Type the Hookup number for the bill you wish to see in the record locator. For example to find 900001 type 900001 No need to push enter the record will appear immediately.

Find Hookup 900001

To find a record by Name, push the record locator button. The button will change from Hookup to Name. Type name or part of a name.

Find Name PETERSON

The F4 Order key has the same effect as pushing the record locator button, with the added action of returning the cursor to the record locator box if the cursor is elsewhere.

In addition to list and name you can find by location, street, meter, route and map.

Location access is for the twelve character location code

Find Locn 01002222A

If you wish to find the account by the street address us Find Street

Find Street 10 Main

type the house and street name or just the street name.

You can also use the VCR button and the action on the view menu to move the Next, Last, Top of File, Bottom of File. These buttons move you through the file in the order shown on the record locator. If the record locator shows Find Name and you push the Next VCR button the hookup with the next Name on file will appear.

Push F5 or pick File, Scan Table to have the computer show you a scan table of the Hookups. The appendices tell you how to locate and select records from a scan table.

How to Add an Account

Pick Edit, Add from the menu. Type the new hookup number of the account you want to add and click Ok.

The computer will display a blank account. Fill in the items. Push tab to move from item to item or use the mouse to move directly to an item.

See the section below if you need an explanation of what goes in each item.

Click on the green check when you are done and the computer will store what you have changed, click Cancel and the computer will let you type it again.

How to Change an Account

Find the account using the record locator the VCR buttons or the View Next, Last, Top Bottom actions.

Move to the item you wish to change and type the new information over the old. You can tab enter to move from item to item, or you can use the mouse to move about in any direction.

See the following section if you need an explanation of what goes in each item.

Click on the green check when you are done and the computer will store what you have changed.

Hookups Tab

Fill in these item for the hookup:

Taxpayer

1
2

Type the taxpayers name, Last name first and their second name. For Example

1 J R SMITH
2 AIR DISTRIBUTING

Address

Mail

Type an addressee line such as a attention or floor. If you are using PO Box in the deliverly Strt item below, you can type the physical street location here.

Strt

Type the taxpayer's mailing address. The post office delivers mail to the address line shown immediately above the city & state.

City
Zip

Type the taxpayers city, state and zip code for their mailing address.

☐ Hide?

If you check this box the name and address of the taxpayer will not be exported to the public or displayed in public inquiry.

☐ Lock?

If you use the link to the assessment system to get new addresses check this box to stop the automatic updating of the address. With this box check the address you place on this hookup will be locked in place.

Property

Locn

Type the location of the property. If you are using coded location type the street and house number in the form sssshhhh and the computer will supply the street name.

Desc

Use this anyway you wish. For example CAR WASH of SPIGOT ON VACANT LAND.

Note

Type a notation. The Locn, Desc, and Note items are displayed along with the Name on the Neptune guns.

Map

Type the map/Bloc/Lot of the property.

Account

If your community uses account numbers, type it here.

Purchased

Date
Vol

If you are going to use Certificates of Assessment to lien property, you can specify the Volumn/Page and Date where the purchase of the property is recorded here.

Liened

Date
Vol

Type date and the Volumn/Page where the deed is recorded.

Released

Date
Vol

Type date and the Volumn/Page where the deed is released.

Meter

Id

If the property has a meter, type the ID number here. If you are using radio read guns, type the ID of the radio transmitter on the meter.

Ser

Type the serial number of the meter.

Gallon
CCF

Pick Gals or CCFs to indicate the unit of measure the meter records.

Siz

Type the size of the meter.

Pos

Type the position or placement of the meter on the structure.

Dgt

The number of digits on the meter

Route

Type reading route or location. if you are using the Neptune guns type the route and sequence separated by a dash for example 12345-6789 is route 12345, sequence 6789

Unit

Use these items any way you wish to help you describe the property. For example indicate the number of dwelling units, or the number of sewer hookups. in Unit. Make up a code to describe the property, for example RES for residential COMM for commercial, etc.

Cd

For Neptune reading devices specify M for Manually typed A for Automatic or probe and Z for Radio Read.

Flags

☐ Stop

Check this box if you wish to stop the production of new bills for this hookup. You can use it to setup an assessment hookup and stop the production of bills until the property is ready.

☐ PayPlan

Check this box to indicate that you have arranged a payment plan for this hookup.

☐ Term?

Check this box to indicate that you have terminated service.

☐ InCol?

Check this box to indicate that the hookup is in collection. This stops the account from being exported to your payment processor.

☐ Protest?

Check this box if the ratepayer is protesting the bill to the sewer commission or court.

☐ BadCk?

Check this box to flag the account for a bad check.

☐ Lien

The computer will check this box when the hookup has been liened.

☐ Active

Check this box to indicate that the account is active. On municipal accounts you wish to keep on file which use utilities but do not receive a bill.

☐ eBill

Check this box to indicate that the account receives bills electronically

Lien

Date
VoIP

Type date and volume-page of the lien.

Release

Date
VoIP

Type date and volume-page of the lien release.

Summary

The item show in the Summary box are available for update on the Water, Sewer and AssmtA and AssmtB Tabs.

Bills Tabs

This tab contains the list of bills you issued, payments and balances. The computer places bills here when you generate them, and payment when you post them.

The bills are listed in date order. The payments against a bill are listed below the bill they pay.

01/01/2005	A1	55.00	.00	.00	.00	01/15/2005
	P1	50.00				050115A
>>		5.00	.00	.00	.00	<<

This is an Assessment A bill for 55.00 dated 01/01/2005
It had one payment posted on 01/15/2005 in batch 040115A
for 50.00 leaving 5.00 due.

Transaction code and sequence on the bill are A for Assessment A bill and 1 for first charge on this date. On the payment the P means Payment, and the 1 means first payment posted on this bill.

Bill Code

A = Assessment A
B = Assessment B
W = Water
S = Sewer

Payment Codes

P = Payment
W = Writeoff acts like a payment but no money received
F = Advance Payment that pays Final Assessment
N = Advance Payment that pays Next Year
I = Payment of added Interest only
V = Void
R = Refund

If you wish to change or delete a bill or payment show here double click on it.

If you wish to add a new bill, click on one of the heading buttons.

If you wish to delete a payment, made in a particular batch Pick Edit, Purge Payment on the menu. The computer will delete all part of the payment.

Sewer/Water Tabs

Use this tab to define the usage groups the hookup belong to, and what charges you wish to levy to form the bill.

Group

Type the number of the rate group which will govern this hookup.

Category

Type the categories of charges with apply to this hookup.

Units

Type the quantity this hookup used of each of the units shown. You defined the units when you setup the rates; The computer will use the rates to develop the charge from the units you supply.
to generate a bill. For Example:

Cat	Unit	Charge
58	1.00	58.00
GL	4431.33	44.31

This tells the computer to generate the next usage bill by multiplying the 58 rate (of 58.00) by 1.00 to get 58.00 and multiplying the GL rate (in this example.10) rate by 4431.33 to get 44.31. The sum of the two changes will form the next bill.

If an R or U appears after the Unit, the computer will use the reading information to for the number for units. For example:

Cat	Unit	Charge
GL	4431.33R	44.31

The gallon units were automatically placed here by the computer based on the difference of the last tow meter readings.

Cat	Unit	Charge
GL	4431.33U	44.31

You cannot change the units if an R or U appears. You must change the reading which support the units. See how to Update Reading below.

AssmtA/AssmtB Tabs

Use this tab to define the assessment groups the hookup belong to, and what charges you wish to levy to form the assessment.

Group

Type the number of the rate group which will govern this hookup.

Category

Type the categories of charges with apply to this hookup.

Units

Type the quantity this hookup used of each of the units shown. You defined the units when you setup the rates; The computer will use the rates to develop the charge from the units you supply.
to generate a bill. For Example:

Cat	Unit	Charge
LA	224.00	2358.00
DP	431.33	1450.00
FL	1.00	2000.00

This tells the computer that the assessment was arrived at by charging for 224 of LA (Lateral) 431.33 of DP (Depth) and one FL charge (Flat) of \$2000.00. These codes are only an example. You define the codes and charges you wish to use in Update Rates.

The date here can be informational. If you do not generate the original assessment and instead rely on your sewer commission to supply you with the assessments you can skip the above and just supply the following items.

☐ Override Installment?
Installment

If you wish to specify the installment you will bill each cycle (year) check this check box and specify the installment amount. If you leave the Override check box unchecked the computer will compute the amount of the installment for you.

Assessed

Type the assessment which will be paid off over a series of years.

Paid to Date

If you are adding this hookup in the middle of an assessment (after a few years of payments) type the amount of the assessment which has been paid off. If it is a new assessment type zero.

Remaining

The computer will compute the assessment remaining and display it here.

CofC Tab

Pick the CofC Tab to see the list of changes you made to the hookup. You cannot change this list here.

Reading Tab

You can access the reading associated with and hookup by picking the Readings Tab. The computer will show you a list of the last 20 reading dates.

To modify or delete a reading, double click on it. The computer will keep the reading in order by the Bill Date.

Added usage is for gallons used but not recorded on the meter, for example water consumed when the meter was broken or not in place.

Place added usage on the latest reading.

Bill Date	Reading	Read Date	Computed Use	Added Use
12/01/2006	56.00	11/23/2006	10.00	44.00
05/01/2006	66.00	04/21/2006		

If you replace a meter, you can either:

1 Put the usage on the old meter as a credit on the new meter. Like this:

Bill Date	Reading	Read Date	Computed Use	Added Use
12/01/2012	56.00	11/23/2012	68.00	.00
05/01/2012	-12.00	04/21/2012		

The 12.00 credit will add to the reading of 56.00 to form a computed use of 68.00.

2. Enter the reading on the meter being replace with the same Bill Date for example if you replaced a meter on 10/11 with a readin of 1982.00 you enter:

12/01/2012	1982.00	10/11/2012
------------	---------	------------

When the reading for the new installed meter arrives the readings will look like this:

Bill Date	Reading	Read Date	Computed Use	Added Use
12/01/2012	56.00	11/23/2012	1056.00R	
12/01/2012	1982.00	10/11/2012	1000.00	
12/01/2011	982.00	10/11/2012		

Since there are two reading for the 12/01/2012 bill date they are added and annotated with an R (Replacement).

To remove a reading double click on it and push the Delete button.

Reader

Readr
Note

Type the meter readers initials or id. The note is transferred to the Neptune guns.

Examine

Inst
Test

Type the meter inspection date and test date.

Change Out

Last
Next

Type the date the meter was last replaced and when it should next be replaced.

☐ Apply Meter Credit From Hookup 999999

Check this box and specify the hookup number of a secondary meter, used for irrigation for example, that you want deducted from the use computed from this hookups meter.

label it

Type the description of the credit, for example IRRIGATION.

Notes Tab

You can access a page of notes associated with and hookup by picking the SeeNote action. The computer will display a page of note you can modify any way you wish.

You can use this area to specify the details of payments plans, keep a record of difficulties with the hookup or meter, or for any purpose you wish.

How To Get the Assessors Name & Address Changes

Pick the Get action and the computer will ask if you wish to get the assessor's name and address changes. You Options hold the ID of the Assessor's system, you wish to work with. You need to put the ID in the options before you can use this action to get changes.

The computer will match you utility hookups to the assessor's accounts by map and change the utility hookups, name, address and property location to match the assessor's data.

How to Delete an Account

Pick the Edit Delete to destroy an account and it associated payments. The computer will only permit you to delete account which have no tax due balance.

When you delete an account you destroy all record of its existance. Thus you need to be certain that you will not be looking for the account OR IT'S ASSOCIATED bills and payment on report you run at a later date.

CofC Change List

Use this program to print a list of changes you made to your accounts.

Report Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will display:

Order

List Order
Date Order
Number Order

Type the first letter of the order you want.

Pick Reason

☐ Pick by Reason
Equals

Check this box and specify a reason code if you wish to limit this report to a particular reason.

Use Units

Use this program to change use units on your hookups.

You can use this program to increase, decrease or replace a unit in an entire rate group. You can also use this program to directly update the use units one hookup at a time.

Update One At A Time

Select the program on the menu and the computer will show you the use units.

Use the record locator, VCR buttons or View menu item to locate hookups you wish to change. See the Update Hookup for example on how to locate records.

Sewer Units

Water Units

Update the unit quantity.

Changing a Group of Units

Pick Replace on the menu and the computer will ask:

Change Unit

Unit

Type the Unit you wish to change.

Change How

Replace
Increase
Decrease

Pick how you wish to change the unit.

Change Amount

Type the amount of the change.

Pick Hookup

☐ Pick Hookup?
From
To

Pick Group

☐ Pick Group?
Group

You can restrict the update to a range of hookup numbers and/or a specific group.

Options

☐ Print a report of changes?

If you want a report of the changes the computer makes check this box.

For example to make all category ST units equal to 5.50 type:

Change Unit

Unit ST

Change How
Replace

Change Amount
Amount 5.50

To increase all category GX by 100.00 type:

Change Unit
Unit GX

Change How
Increase

Change Amount
Amount 100.00

To zero all category 2F categories type:

Change Unit
Unit ZF

Change How
Replace

Change Amount
Amount 0.00

Print a Report

Pick File, Report to print a report of any unit you specify.

Pick Unit

Type the unit you wish to print.

☐ Pick by Value?
From
To

If you wish to only print units containing specific values
check this box and specify the range of values to select.

Readings

Use this program to update readings.

You can use this program to type readings, if you do not import the readings from a file or meter guns.

Update Readings

Use the record locator, VCR buttons or View menu item to locate hookups you wish to change. See the Update Hookup section for example on how to locate records.

Reading

Type the reading.

Reading Date

Type the date the reading was taken. This is for your reference only, so if you have no need to record the reading date use the bill date.

Bill Date

Type the date of the bill for which you are entering the reading.

Type

Indicate if you are typing a Reading that will be used to compute consumption by subtracting it from a prior reading or Use that will be used as you type it.

When typing a series of readings, you can fill-in all of the items for the first reading, and then change just the reading and possibly the reading date to enter other readings.

Flags

Use this program to rapidly set or clear flags.
You can use it to rapidly mark individual accounts or
to group change a range of accounts.

How Update a Flag

Select the program on the menu and specify the flag you
wish to update from the drop down box.

Which Flag

- 1 Terminate
- 2 Lien
- 3 Open
- 4 Protest
- 5 Stop
- 6 BadChk
- 7 oPEN
- 8 Other
- 9 PayPlan

Find the account using the record locator or the VCR buttons.
When you have located the account, pick the mark or Erase menu
selection to set or clear the flag.

How to Group Set a Flag

If you wish to change the status on all accounts in a
particular file or range pick the File, Replace

Make the Flag

Code now Yes
New Code No

Pick By Hookup

☐ Pick By Hookup?
From:900001
To: 900006

This example will make the active flag No if it is Yes for
hookups between 900001 and 900006.

Set Rates

Use this program to tell the system about a rate group. A rate group is a group of accounts, either usage or assessment, which are billed using the same rates on the same schedule.

A rate group tells the computer the name of the group and the range of accounts it covers. It also defines the delinquent and bond interest rates and the rates which are applied to the units to create a bill.

Finding Groups

Use the record locator to find an group. Type the Code for the group you wish to see in the record locator. For example to find group AA type AA. No need to push enter the record will appear immediately.

Find by Code AA

You can also use the VCR buttons and the actions on the view menu to move the Next, Last, Top of File, Bottom of File

Push F5 or pick View, Scan Table to have the computer show you a scan table of the groups. The appendices tell you how to locate and select records from a scan table.

How to Add a Group

Pick Edit, Add from the menu.

The computer will display a blank account. Fill in the items. Push tab to move from item to item or use the mouse to move directly to an item.

See the section below if you need an explanation of what goes in each item.

Click on the green check when you are done and the computer will save the data.

How to Change an Account

Find the account using the record locator or the Next, Last actions. The computer will display the group. Move to the item you wish to change and type the new information over the old. You can tab to move from item to item, or you can use the mouse to move about in any direction.

See the following section if you need an explanation of what goes in each item.

Rate Group Data

Here is how to fill in the items:

Code

Type the two letter code you wish to update or delete. If you are adding a group, make up a new two character code. You may wish to use U1, U2, U3, etc. for usage groups and A1, A2, A3 for assessment groups, but you may make up the code in anyway you wish. Use two characters for the code.

Name

Type the name of the group in words, be brief but descriptive, for example West End Assessment.

Type

Usage
Assessment

Pick Assessment for Assessment Groups or Usage for Usage Groups.

Project

A Project number or name.

Cycle

A number 00-99 indicating the billing group or cycle.

Last Billed

Date

If you are adding a group type the date you intend to send out the first bills. The computer will update this item for you each time you send out bills.

Delq Interest

Annual Rate

Type the annual delinquent interest rate. If the delinquent interest rate is 18% per year type .1800 here. If you change a delinquent rate, and save the change, the system will ask if you want it only to use it from today forward. If you respond Yes the system will lock-in the prior interest rate to date.

Bond/Assessment

Bond Rate

Type the annual bond interest rate. You only have to fill this in if you are defining an assessment group.

Compound

Indicate the compounding period of the bond rate.

First Bill

Type the date of the first assessment bill. This may also be the date you started the assessment group.

Number Years

Type the number of installments the taxpayers will paying this assessment. You only have to fill this in if you are defining an assessment group.

☐ Even Installments

Check this box if you want the total bill amount, the combination of principal and bond interest to be the same each installment.

Installments

Specify the number of installments per year Annual (1), Semi Annual (2) or Monthly (12).

Defining the Rates

Tell the computer how you want it to derive a bill in this group:

Fees

Flat Charge
Sewer Minimum
Water Minimum
Lien Fee

Type the charges which apply to all accounts in the group. The Flat Charge will be charged without regard to any unit of usage or measurement. The Minimums will be charged if the charged if the bill is computed to be less than this amount. The lien fee will be charged should you lien an account.

Fees

Flat Charge 45.00
Sewer Minimum 60.00
Water Minimum 60.00
Lien Fee 24.00

This tells the computer to charge every account 45.00 and if the bill does not calculate to be at least 60.00 charge 60.00.

Rate Table

Use the rate table to define the rates for the group. Each account can have up to six of these categories used to calculate the water or sewer use bill. Modify a line in the table by double clicking on it. Add a new line by clicking on any table heading.

Cat

Type a two two letter identification of the category such as US, M1, or 58,

Name

Type a short description such as WATER USE.

Use

Type an R if this charge category is based on metered usage derived from the meter reading data. Type C if the computed consumption is to be divided by 100 (100 ccf) or G if the consumption data is to be divided by 745 (gals).

From
To

Type the rage of values this rate applies to.

Disc

If you wish you can show a factor modifying the number of units you are billing.

Rate

Type the rate you are charging per unit.

Example of Rates

Say you define a sewer usage group and wish to bill each account in the group 45.00 plus .08 per gallon and a fee based on the size of their meter. If the account has no meter (only a well) you wish to charge \$210.00. In addition you wanted to charge at least \$100.00. You would define the rates as follows:

Fees	
Flat Charge	45.00
Sewer Minimum	100.00
Water Minimum	200.00
Lien Fee	.00

This tells the computer to charge every account 45.00 and if the bill does not calculate to be at least 100.00 based on all of the other units charge 60.00.

-Cat-	Name-----	Use-From--	To-----	Factor---	Rate----
:W1	:WELL	: :	.00	999999.99:	: 210.00
:GL	:GALLON USE	:R:	.00	999999.99:	: 0.08
:12	:1/2" METER	: :	.00	999999.99:	: 25.00
:58	:5/8 METER	: :	.00	999999.99:	: 35.00
:01	:8" METER	: :	.00	999999.99:	: 55.00
:	:	: :	.00	999999.99:	:

This tells the computer to multiply every gallon indicated on each account (GL) times .08 to develop the charge and to multiply every well (W1) unit on the account by 210.00. (Perhaps well users dump the water into the sewers and have no meter to read.)

The R on the GL category indicates that you want the computer to load the use (from the readings) into the units on each account.

In addition the computer will charge \$25 times the number of units for any account which has the 12 category. Likewise for \$35 for accounts coded 58 and \$55 for accounts coded 01. You can design the codes any way you wish. Here they correspond to meter sizes or 1/2", 5/8" and 1" respectively.

A taxpayer's account who has 1000 gallons of usage and a 5/8" METER would show:

Cat	Name	Units
:58	:5/8" METER	: 1
:GL	:R:GALLON USE	: 1000

This account would receive a bill of 160.00 computed as shown below.

1	FLAT FEE	=	45.00
1	5/8" METER @	35.00=	35.00
1000.00	GALLON USE @	.08=	80.00

Delinquent Interest Rates

The delinquent interest rate is defined for each group. Should State Statutes direct you to modify all of the rates you can use the action, File, Interest Change to change the rate on all of your Groups.

Create New Bills

Use this program to add new water bills for a group of accounts. The computer will use unit information on the hookups and the rates you defined for the group to compute an amount and create a bill.

Preparing to Create New Bills

First, be certain you have set the rates you want to charge. Pick Set Rates, locate the group and check the rate you have defined for the group.

Second, Double check the hookup information you have on file for each hookup in the group. Pay special attention to accounts which have special one time charges.

How to Create New Bills

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you how you want the bills printed.

New Water Bills
Date of Bill 01/01/2008
How Many Installments?

Type the date of the bill. If you reuse a bill date you used before the computer will replace the earlier bills with the one you are creating now.

If you wish to split the billed amount into equal installments due over the next year, indicate how many installments you wish to use. You can use 1, 2 or 4.

If you specify more than one installment the computer will also ask you for this item after you click the green check:

Split if over \$ 100.00

Type maximum fee to be billed in one installment.

Group
☐ Pick Group?
Group

If you wish to create bills for just one group, check this box, and type the group code. If you wish to produce bill for all hookups, un check this box.

Hookups
☐ Pick Hookups?
From
To

If you wish to create bills for a particular range of hookups check this box and specify the hookup range.

Report Format
Full, Every Bill
Exemptions Only

Pick Full to have each bill printed on a report showing you the amount of the bill created. Pick Exemptions if you just wish to see hookup who did not get a bill created.

Create New Bills

Use this program to add new sewer bills for a group of accounts. The computer will use unit information on the hookups and the rates you defined for the group to compute an amount and create a bill.

Preparing to Create New Bills

First, be certain you have set the rates you want to charge. Pick Set Rates, locate the group and check the rate you have defined for the group.

Second, Double check the hookup information you have on file for each hookup in the group. Pay special attention to accounts which have special one time charges.

How to Create New Bills

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you how you want the bills printed.

New Water Bills

'-Date of Bill 01/01/2008
How Many Installments?

Type the date of the bill. If you reuse a bill date you used before the computer will replace the earlier bills with the one you are creating now.

If you wish to split the billed amount into equal installments due over the next year, indicate how many installments you wish to use. You can use 1, 2 or 4.

If you specify more than one installment the computer will also ask you for this item after you click the green check:

Split if over \$ 100.00

Type maximum fee to be bill in one installment.

Group

☐ Pick Group?
Group

If you wish to create bills for just one group, check this box, and type the group code. If you wish to produce bill for all hookups, un check this box.

Hookups

☐ Pick Hookups?
From
To

If you wish to create bills for a particular range of hookups check this box and specify the hookup range.

Report Format

Full, Every Bill
Exemptions Only

Pick Full to have each bill printed on a report showing you the amount of the bill created. Pick Exemptions if you just wish to see hookup who did not get a bill created.

Create New Bills

Use this program to add a new assessment bills. The computer will use the assessment balances on hookups and the rate group definition to generate new bills for the dates you request.

How to Create New Assessment Bills

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you how you want the bills created.

New Assmt Bills

From 03/01/2003
To 03/31/2003

Specify the dates of the bills you wish to create. For example if you wish to create a a new bill for 2003 for all assessments who have bills issued during March specify the dates as shown above. If you wish to generate just bills that you issue on March first specify

New Assmt Bills

From 03/01/2003
To 03/01/2003

If you reuse bill dates you used before the computer will not replace the earlier bills with the one you are now trying to recreate. To replace bills first us File, Purge Bills to remove the earlier set, and then use this program to crate them again.

Action

Create Bills
Report Only

Pick Report Only to only print a report showing the new bills, and not add the new bills to the file. Pick Create Bills to add the new bills to the file too.

☐ Only Select Assessment? (First, Reoccurring)

Check this box to have the computer only pick a hookup only if it is having the fist bill issued, or just reoccurring bills.

☐ Only Select (Frequency)

Check this and specify the assessment installment frequency to select a specific one.

☐ Show zero bills on report?

Check this to show hookup wich qualify based on the dates you specified, but have no new bill issued because they are paid in full, or have another condition.

Group

☐ Pick Group? AA

If you wish to create bills for just one group, check this check box and type the Group ID. If you you wish to produce bills for all groups, un check this check box.

Hookups

☐ Pick Hookups?
From
To

If you wish to create bills for a particular range of hookups, check the Pick Hookups? box and specify the hookup range.

☐ Apply Lien Fee of \$ 24.00

Check this box and the specify the amount of the lien fee, if you wish to add fees to al the bills you are creating.

Rate Book

Use this program to print a rate book for one billing date. The book shows the hookup information along with the taxes due and payments made for any one bill.

Report Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask:

Format

Full
Abbreviated
Laser Book
Totals Only

Pick Full to print all rate data. Pick Abbreviated to print an abbreviated book showing just the bill and balance due. Totals only will print just the final total pages. Pick Laser Book to print a book with boxes.

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the report order you want.

Type

Water Use
Sewer Use
A Assessment
B Assessment

Pick the type of bill you wish to print in the book.

Balances

Total Due
Only Fee Due

Pick Only Fee Due to print in the book the balance of the fee you billed. Pick Total Due to print the balance including interest, as well.

Pick Billings

Date1 01/01/2002
☒ Pick second data too?
Date2 07/01/2002

Specify the date or dates you want printed in this rate book. The example above will print the bills issued in january and July of 2002.

Interest Date

Thru

Type the date you wish to use to compute interest.

Cutoff Batch
Thru

You can limit the presentation to transactions posted through a particular date by specifying it here. For example if you type 01/01/2002 no payment posted in a batch date after 01/01/2002 will be reflected in the book.

Pick Unit

What Unit
From
To

You can select account for inclusion in the book by the contents of a particular unit. For example say you have a unit call GL for gallons consumed. If you specify

Pick Unit

What Unit GL
From 1000.00
To 999999.99

You will select account who have a GL unit whose value is 1000 to 999999.
limit the

Pick Balance

From
To

You can also limit the book to balances in a particular range for example

Pick Balance

From .00
To .99

Will select account with balance under \$1.

Range Select

As with other report it is possible to further limit the book to ranges of these items:

- ☐ Hookup
- ☐ Name
- ☐ Locn
- ☐ Map
- ☐ Route
- ☐ Meter
- ☐ Size

For example to pick hookups with maps 01-001 to 02-233 and whose surname begins with N specify:

- ☐ Hookup
- ☒ Name MA MZ
- ☐ Locn
- ☒ Map 01 001 02 233
- ☐ Route
- ☐ Meter
- ☐ Size

Notice that you check this item you wish to pick and then specify the range you wish to select. The hookup must meet all of the selections to be included in the report. That means in this example folks whose last name start with N but who do not live in maps 01-001 to 020233 will not be included on the report.

Billing Ledger

Use this program to print a book reflecting a set of bill.

Report Options

Pick the program on the menu and the computer will ask

Format

Full
Abbreviated
Totals Only

Pick Full to print a multi line presentation for each bill showing what was bill and the units. Pick Abbreviated to see a shortened book showing just he amount billed. Pick Totals only to see the final total pages only.

Type

Usage
Water
Sewer
A Assessment
B Assessment

Pick the type of charge you are printing in the book. Usage will print both Water and Sewer changes.

Interest Date

Thru

Type the date you wish to use to compute interest.

Cutoff Date

Thru

Type the day you wish included on the report.

Pick Billing

Date: 01/01/1999

Type the date of the bill you wish to print in the book.

☐ Print Unit Totals?

Check this box to have the computer print totals of units the bill were based upon.

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Bill Balances

Use this program to print a list of bill's balances.

How to Operate

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask:

```
Order
0 Group/Hookup
1 Hookup
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter
```

Pick the report order you want.

```
Type
A Assessment
B Assessment
```

Pick the type of bill you wish to print in the book.

```
Interest Date
Thru
```

Type the date you wish to use to compute interest.

```
Cutoff Batch
Thru
```

You can limit the presentation to transactions posted through a particular date by specifying it here. For example if you type 01/01/2002 no bill date after this date or payment posted in a batch date after 01/01/2002 will be reflected in the book.

☐ Print bill totals by Fiscal Year?

Check this box to have the final bills totals subtotaled by fiscal year. If you leave this unchecked they will be subtotaled by bill year.

☐ Print bill group total?

Check this box to print totals by the billing groups.

☐ Print Hookup mailing address?

Check this box to print the hookup's mailing address.

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Hookup List

Use this program to print a list of your accounts. This report will print the hookup information only, no bill or payment information is presented.

How to Operate

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you:

Format

Full
Unit Book
Totals Only

Pick Full to print all hookup data. Pick Use Unit Book to print an abbreviated book showing just the usage units. Pick "A" to print a book showing assessment balances.

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the report order you want.

Pick the report order by typing the number in show next to the order you want.

Type

Use Book
Assmt Book

Pick Use Book to see the Units related to Use bills. Pick Assmt Book to see the assessment information.

Pick by Group

☐ Pick by Group?
Group

To limit the book to just one Rate Group check this box and specify the group code.

Pick Status

All Status
Stopped
Terminated
Not Feeable

If you wish to limit the list to hookups with a particular status pick it here. Not Feeable is not taxable.

Assessment Books

For books showing assessment accounts, you may pick by the assessment balance remaining or the status of the account, that is, if they are on schedule or behind.

Pick By Assessment
☐ Pick Assessment?
From 5000.00
To 9999999.00

This example will select hookups whose assessment remaining is \$5000 or more.

Pick Status

Any Status
On Time
Behind
Prepaid
XOver
Disagree

In addition to look for statues the Disagree status will pick accounts whose payments on file do not add to the Paid-To-Date item. They normally should, however if you started the assessment in the middle of the run, your computer may not have bills and payments for all years which the assessment covers.

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Statement List

Use this program to print a list of account showing the bill balances, much as they appear individual statements.

Report Options

Indicate the format and order of the book

Format

Abbreviated
Full
Totals Only

The full book shows the original bill, payments, credits and the present balance. The Abbreviated book shows one detail line per bill showing its balance.

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the report order you want.

Type

Water Use
Sewer Use
A Assessment
B Assessment

Pick the type of bill you wish to print in the book.

Interest Date

Thru

Type the date you wish to compute interest through.

Pick by Date

☐ Pick Bills
From
To

Check this box and specify the date range of bills you wish to see if you wish to limit the report. For example to see all bills since 1988 through 1997 type:

Pick by Date

☒ Pick Bills
From 01/01/88
To 12/31/97

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Top Delinquent List

Use this program to print a list of hookups ordered by the amount now due.

Report Options

Order

Ascending Due
Descending Due

Pick Descending due to see the hookup order form the largest due to the smallest due.

Type

Usage
Water Only
Sewer Only
Just Assessment
A Assmt Only
B Assmt

Pick the type of bills you wish to use for balances that print in the report.

Interest Date

Thru

Type the date you wish to compute interest through.

Cutoff Date

Thru

Type the day you wish included on the report.

☐ Pick Balances

From
To

Check this box and specify a range of balances to have the report restricted to hookups whose balance due fall in the range.

☐ Print Hookup Address?

Check this box to print the hookup's mail address.

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Labels/Postcards

Use this program to print address labels or post cards.

Label Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will display

Format

- 1 Name/Address
- 2 Meter

Pick the format of the label you would like to print.

Order

- 1 List
- 2 Name
- 3 Location
- 4 Map
- 5 Route
- 6 Meter

Pick the order you want.

Format

- Usage
- Water
- Sewer
- A Assmt
- B Assmt

Pick the type of hookups you want to print. Usage select hookups that have water or sewer.

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Cross Reference

Use this program to print one line per account cross reference list.

How to Operate

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you:

Format

Full
Abbreviated

Pick Full to print all the cross reference item and the taxpayers mailing address. Pick Abbreviated to skip the mailing address.

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the report order you want.

☐ Print Descriptions?

Check this box to have the computer include the data you have in the Desc item on the report.

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Memorized Reports

Use this program to pick and run a memorized report. A report is memorized and placed on this list when you pick Option, Memorize from the menu in a report program.

All of the memorized report form all of systems users are placed on this list.

How to Operate

To run a report shown on the list either highlight it and click on the OK button or just double click on the report.

You can delete a report form this table by pushing the Delete button on the toolbar.

You can print a list of the reports by pushing the print button on the toolbar.

Frequently Asked Questions

How can I change the name of a memorized report?

Pick the report, and re-memorize it under the new name. Then delete the old report.

Water Use Bills

Use this program to print Water bills.

This program only prints bills, which you may do at any time. It does not change the account in any way.

How to Print Water Bills

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you how you want the bills printed.

Water Bills

Date of Bill 12/01/1999

Specify the date of the bill you wish to print. For an installment bill specify the first bill date.

Order

Hookup
Zip Code
Individual

Pick the order you want the bill printed. If you specify Individual the computer will permit you to specify the hookups you wish to print by picking them from a scan table.

Interest Date

Thru: 12/01/1999

Type the date you want the computer to use in calculating delinquent interest.

Pick Groups

☒ Pick group?
Group AA

Pick Hookup

☒ Pick Hookup?
From 900001
To 900999

If you wish to limit the bills you print to a specific group or range of hookup number specify them here. The above will pick bill from hookup 100001 to 100999 which are also in group 99.

Bill Text

Print Dates

Due Date 12/01/1999
Pay Before 01/02/2000

Cover Dates

From 09/01/1999
To 12/01/1999

Type the dates you would like printed on the bill.

Top Message

Type the text of the message you would like to print at the top centered of each bill.

Message

☐ Print Stub message?

Check this box if you wish to print a text message on the bill.

☐ Use text below?

Check this box and fill in the text you wish to print on the bottom stub instead of a third copy of the bill.

[*]Print Stub message from file bmess.txt

You can create your message using Notepad and save it to a text file. To print the saved message check this box and specify the name of the file. In the example above the computer will look for a text file called bmess.txt located in your working \tax folder.

Frequently Asked Questions

One of my accounts with a past credit and and a current charge which total zero did not print, Why?

A bill will be print for any account which has a current charge and a total bill balance not zero.

Sewer Use Bills

Use this program to print usage bills.

This program only prints bills, which you may do at any time. It does not change the account in any way.

How to Print Usage Bills

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you how you want the bills printed.

Sewer Bills
Date of Bill 12/01/20029

Specify the date of the bill you wish to print. For an installment bill specify the first bill date.

Pick the bill format you wish to print.

Order
Hookup
Zip Code
Individual

Pick the order you want the bill printed. If you specify Individual the computer will permit you to specify the hookups you wish to print by picking them from a scan table.

Interest Date
Thru: 12/01/1999

Type the date you want the computer to use in calculating delinquent interest.

Pick Groups
☒ Pick group?
Group AA

Pick Hookup
☒ Pick Hookup?
From 900001
To 900999

If you wish to limit the bills you print to a specific group or range of hookup number specify them here. The above will pick bill form hookup 100001 to 100999 which are also in group 99.

Bill Text

Print Dates
Due Date 12/01/1999
Pay Before 01/02/2000

Type the dates you would like printed on the bill. For installment and coupon bills specify the dates for all of the installments.

Cover Dates
From 09/01/1999
To 12/01/1999

Type the dates you would like printed on the bill.

Top Message

Type the text of the message you would like to print

at the top centered of each bill.

Message

☐ Print Stub message?

Check this box if you wish to print a text message on the bill.

☐ Use text below?

Check this box and fill in the text you wish to print on the bottom stub instead of a third copy of the bill.

[*]Print Stub message from file bmess.txt

You can create your message using Notepad and save it to a text file. To print the saved message check this box and specify the name of the file. In the example above the computer will look for a text file called bmess.txt located in your working \tax folder.

Frequently Asked Questions

One of my accounts with a past credit and and a current charge which total zero did not print, Why?

A bill will be print for any account which has a current charge and a total bill balance not zero.

Combined Use Bills

Use this program to print a combined Water & Sewer bills.

This program only prints bills, which you may do at any time. It does not change the account in any way.

How to Print Usage Bills

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you how you want the bills printed.

Sewer Bills

☒ Print Water?

Date of Bill 12/01/20029

If you want the computer to print Sewer charges check this box and specify the data of the charge.

Water Bills

☒ Print Water?

Date of Bill 12/01/1999

If you want the computer to print Water charges check this box and specify the data of the charge.

Order

Hookup
Zip Code
Individual

Pick the order you want the bill printed. If you specify Individual the computer will permit you to specify the hookups you wish to print by picking them from a scan table.

Interest Date

Thru: 12/01/1999

Type the date you want the computer to use in calculating delinquent interest.

Pick Groups

☒ Pick group?

Group AA

Pick Hookup

☒ Pick Hookup?

From 900001

To 900999

If you wish to limit the bills you print to a specific group or range of hookup number specify them here. The above will pick bill from hookup 100001 to 100999 which are also in group 99.

Bill Text

Print Dates

Due Date 12/01/1999

Pay Before 01/02/2000

Type the dates you would like printed on the bill. For installment and coupon bills specify the dates for all of the installments.

Cover Dates

From 09/01/1999

Type the dates you would like printed on the bill.

Top Message

Type the text of the message you would like to print at the top centered of each bill.

Message

☐ Print Stub message?

Check this box if you wish to print a text message on the bill.

☐ Use text below?

Check this box and fill in the text you wish to print on the bottom stub instead of a third copy of the bill.

[*]Print Stub message from file bmess.txt

You can create your message using Notepad and save it to a text file. To print the saved message check this box and specify the name of the file. In the example above the computer will look for a text file called bmess.txt located in your working \tax folder.

Frequently Asked Questions

One of my accounts with a past credit and and a current charge which total zero did not print, Why?

A bill will be print for any account which has a current charge and a total bill balance not zero.

Assessment Bills

Use this program to print assessment bills.

This program only prints bill forms, which you may do at any time. It does not change the account or bill in any way.

How to Operate

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you how you want the bills printed.

Assessment A Bills
☐ Print Assmt A Bills?
From
To

Check this box and specify the date range of the assessment A bills you wish to print.

Assessment B Bills
☐ Print Assmt B Bills?
From
To

Check this box and specify the date range of the assessment B bills you wish to print.

Order
Hookup
Zip Code
Individual

Select the order you want to print the bills. Pick Individual to pick the hookup number you wish to print from a scan table.

Pick By Group
Pick Group?
Group

If you wish to limit the bill to a particular rate group, check the box and specify the code of the group you wish to print.

Pick By Hookup
Pick Hookup?
From
To

If you wish to limit the bill to a range of hookup number, check this box and specify the hookup range.

☐ Override Dates
Interest Thru
Pay Before

If you are printing bill for 1 bill date and wish to specify the Interest and Due Date, check this box and specify them here. If you want the computer to figure the dates for you for each bill it prints, leave this checkbox unchecked.

Bill Text

Direct Question
Amount Assessment to

Type the name and phone number of the person who can answer question about how the bill was derived.

Dates

Due Date
Pay Before

Type the date you would like show printed as the Due Date and the pay before date

Top message

Type a message you would like to appear at the top center of each bill form.

Message

☐ Print Message?

Check this box and specify the text of a message you would like to print on the bottom third of the bill page. Uncheck this box to have the computer print a third bill image.

Bill File For

Use this program to create bill file to send to SAP.

Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask:

Assessment A Bills

☐ Pick Assmt A?
From
To

Assessment B Bills

☐ Pick Assmt B?
From
To

Specify the range of bill dates you want to select.

Pick byCycle

☐ Pick Cycle?
From
To

Specify the range of cycles you want to select.

If you specify both Pick By Date and Pick Cycle the bill will be grouped in files by cycle.

Say you specify

Pick By Date? Yes
From 07/01/2020
To 07/01/2020

and

Pick Cycle? Yes
From 01
To 15

This will select all Assessment A bills due during July that have bill cycles 01 through 15.
So if there are three bills due on July like this

07/01/2020 Cycle 0
107/10/2020 Cycle 04
07/15/2020 Cycle 18

And you request this on 06/27/2020 at 10am, These file will be produced

NMC20200701.tt
H 20200627100000 timestamp
D 07/01/2020 bill

NMC20200704.txt

H 202006271000002 timestamp
pD 07/10/2020 bill

07/15/2020 Cycle 18 is skipped because the request is for 01 to 15.

If you do not request the bills by cycle the bills will be grouped by bill date:

NMC20200701.tt
H 20200627100000 timestamp
D 07/01/2020 bill

NMC20200104.txt
H 202006271000002 timestap
D 07/10/2020 bill

NMC2020015.txt
H 202006271000002 timestap
D 07/15/2020 bill

Pick by Hookups

☐ Pick Hookups
From
To

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular range of hookup, check this box and specify the hookup number range.

Pick by Group

☐ Pick Group?

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular group check this check box and specify the group.

Pick by Frequency

☐ Pick Frequency

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular installment frequency check this and pick the frequency: Annual, Semi Annual or Monthly.

Bill File For

Use this program to print delinquent bill notices, notices to lien or to address letters.

Notice Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask:

Type

Water Use
Sewer Use
A Assessment
B Assessment

Pick the type of bill you wish to print.

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the report order you want.

Interest Date

Thru

Type the date you wish to use to compute interest.

Cutoff Batch
Thru

You can limit the presentation to transactions posted through a particular date by specifying it here. For example if you type 01/01/2002 no bill dated after this date or payment posted in a batch date after 01/01/2002 will be reflected on the statements.

Hookups

☐ Pick Hookups
From
To

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular range of hookup, check this box and specify the hookup number range.

Unpaid Balances

☐ Pick Unpaid?
From
To

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular range of unpaid balances, check this box and specify the range of balances. Unpaid balances are all monies billed and not yet paid.

Delinquent Balances

☐ Pick Delinquent?
From
To

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular range of Delinquent balances, check this box and specify the range of balances. Delinquent balances are all unpaid monies billed in other than the current billing cycle.

Taxing Body

Type the text describing who you are to the taxpayer,
For example: First District of Eastford.

Pay To Name

For the Attorney Letter type the text describing how the
ratepayer should make their check payable to. For example:
Eastford.

Name of Change

Type text describing the fee you are billing, for example
Water Use.

Attorney Name

Type the name of the attorney for the signature line.

Message

If you are printing Notices to Lien, Shut Off Notices or
Delineuqent notices you can add extra text.

☐ Print Stub message?

Check this box if you wish to print a text message on the bill.

☐ Use text below?

Check this box and fill in the text you wish to print on the
bottom stub instead of a third copy of the bill.

[*]Print Stub message from file bmess.txt

You can create your message using Notepad and save it to a text
file. To print the saved message check this box and specify
the name of the file. In the example above the computer will
look for a text file called bmess.txt located in your working
\\tax folder.

☐ Print Stub message in backside of bill (Duplex)?

Check this box to have the computer print the stub message on the
back side of the bill. You need to have a duplex printer, and have
it set to duplex for the message to print on the back side otherwise
you will get the message on a second sheet.

Webster eTran

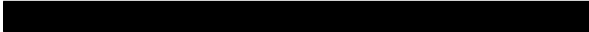
Your ETran ID
Your Etran Bank

Type the ID and Bank ID eTran assigned you.

Bank Agency File

When the process copletes the Copy To dialog opens so you can direct
the file to removable media or the Bank/Agency Download Site.

The format of the file is on the Bank/Agency Download Site.



Questions

How do print my signature on Lien and Shutoff Notice?.

Create a .jpg file of your signature about 180 high x 680 wide.
Place it in your working foldered as ser-sig.jpg.

Delinquent Notices

Use this program to print delinquent bill notices, notices to lien or to address letters.

Notice Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask:

Type

Water Use
Sewer Use
A Assessment
B Assessment

Pick the type of bill you wish to print.

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the report order you want.

Interest Date

Thru

Type the date you wish to use to compute interest.

Cutoff Batch
Thru

You can limit the presentation to transactions posted through a particular date by specifying it here. For example if you type 01/01/2002 no bill dated after this date or payment posted in a batch date after 01/01/2002 will be reflected on the statements.

Hookups

☐ Pick Hookups
From
To

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular range of hookup, check this box and specify the hookup number range.

Unpaid Balances

☐ Pick Unpaid?
From
To

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular range of unpaid balances, check this box and specify the range of balances. Unpaid balances are all monies billed and not yet paid.

Delinquent Balances

☐ Pick Delinquent?
From
To

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular range of Delinquent balances, check this box and specify the range of balances. Delinquent balances are all unpaid monies billed in other than the current billing cycle.

Taxing Body

Type the text describing who you are to the taxpayer,
For example: First District of Eastford.

Pay To Name

For the Attorney Letter type the text describing how the
ratepayer should make their check payable to. For example:
Eastford.

Name of Change

Type text describing the fee you are billing, for example
Water Use.

Attorney Name

Type the name of the attorney for the signature line.

Message

If you are printing Notices to Lien, Shut Off Notices or
Delineuqent notices you can add extra text.

☐ Print Stub message?

Check this box if you wish to print a text message on the bill.

☐ Use text below?

Check this box and fill in the text you wish to print on the
bottom stub instead of a third copy of the bill.

[*]Print Stub message from file bmess.txt

You can create your message using Notepad and save it to a text
file. To print the saved message check this box and specify
the name of the file. In the example above the computer will
look for a text file called bmess.txt located in your working
\\tax folder.

☐ Print Stub message in backside of bill (Duplex)?

Check this box to have the computer print the stub message on the
back side of the bill. You need to have a duplex printer, and have
it set to duplex for the message to print on the back side otherwise
you will get the message on a second sheet.

Webster eTran

Your ETran ID
Your Etran Bank

Type the ID and Bank ID eTran assigned you.

Bank Agency File

When the process copletes the Copy To dialog opens so you can direct
the file to removable media or the Bank/Agency Download Site.

The format of the file is on the Bank/Agency Download Site.



Questions

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Create a .jpg file of your signature about 180 high x 680 wide.
Place it in your working foldered as ser-sig.jpg.

Delinquent Notices

Use this program to print delinquent bill notices, notices to lien or to address letters.

Notice Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask:

Type

Water Use
Sewer Use
A Assessment
B Assessment

Pick the type of bill you wish to print.

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the report order you want.

Interest Date

Thru

Type the date you wish to use to compute interest.

Cutoff Batch
Thru

You can limit the presentation to transactions posted through a particular date by specifying it here. For example if you type 01/01/2002 no bill dated after this date or payment posted in a batch date after 01/01/2002 will be reflected on the statements.

Hookups

☐ Pick Hookups
From
To

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular range of hookup, check this box and specify the hookup number range.

Unpaid Balances

☐ Pick Unpaid?
From
To

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular range of unpaid balances, check this box and specify the range of balances. Unpaid balances are all monies billed and not yet paid.

Delinquent Balances

☐ Pick Delinquent?
From
To

If you wish to limit the notices to a particular range of Delinquent balances, check this box and specify the range of balances. Delinquent balances are all unpaid monies billed in other than the current billing cycle.

Taxing Body

Type the text describing who you are to the taxpayer,
For example: First District of Eastford.

Pay To Name

For the Attorney Letter type the text describing how the
ratepayer should make their check payable to. For example:
Eastford.

Name of Change

Type text describing the fee you are billing, for example
Water Use.

Attorney Name

Type the name of the attorney for the signature line.

Message

If you are printing Notices to Lien, Shut Off Notices or
Delineuqent notices you can add extra text.

☐ Print Stub message?

Check this box if you wish to print a text message on the bill.

☐ Use text below?

Check this box and fill in the text you wish to print on the
bottom stub instead of a third copy of the bill.

[*]Print Stub message from file bmess.txt

You can create your message using Notepad and save it to a text
file. To print the saved message check this box and specify
the name of the file. In the example above the computer will
look for a text file called bmess.txt located in your working
\\tax folder.

☐ Print Stub message in backside of bill (Duplex)?

Check this box to have the computer print the stub message on the
back side of the bill. You need to have a duplex printer, and have
it set to duplex for the message to print on the back side otherwise
you will get the message on a second sheet.

Webster eTran

Your ETran ID
Your Etran Bank

Type the ID and Bank ID eTran assigned you.

Bank Agency File

When the process copletes the Copy To dialog opens so you can direct
the file to removable media or the Bank/Agency Download Site.

The format of the file is on the Bank/Agency Download Site.



Questions

How do print my signature on Lien and Shutoff Notice?.

Create a .jpg file of your signature about 180 high x 680 wide.
Place it in your working foldered as ser-sig.jpg.

Assessment Notices

Use this program to Initial Assessment Notices.

This program only prints forms, which you may do at any time. It does not change the hookup or bill in any way.

How to Operate

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you how you want the notices printed.

Assessment A Bills
☐ Print Assmt A Bills?
From
To

Check this box and specify the date range of the assessment A bills you wish to print.

Assessment B Bills
☐ Print Assmt B Bills?
From
To

Check this box and specify the date range of the assessment B bills you wish to print.

Order
Hookup
Zip Code
Individual

Select the order you want to print the bills. Pick Individual to pick the hookup number you wish to print from a scan table.

Pick By Group
Pick Group?
Group

If you wish to limit the bill to a particular rate group, check the box and specify the code of the group you wish to print.

Pick By Hookup
Pick Hookup?
From
To

If you wish to limit the bill to a range of hookup number, check this box and specify the hookup range.

☐ Override Dates
Interest Thru
Pay Before

If you are printing notices for one bill date and wish to specify the Interest and Due Date, check this box and specify them here. If you want the computer to figure the dates for you for each bill it prints, leave this checkbox unchecked.

Statements

Use this program to print statements. You can also use the Posting Program to print statement one at a time.

Statement Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask:

Format

Full
Abbreviated

Pick Full to have each bill and all its relates payments shown. Pick Abbreviated to have one balance line shown per bill.

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the report order you want.

Cutoff Date

Thru

Leave this date set to today if you want the statement to reflect all activity, bills and payment, through today. If you wish to back-date the statement, type the last date of the activity you want reflected on the statement.

Interest Date

Thru

Type the date you wish to use to compute interest.

Pick Balance

From
To

You can also limit the statements to balances in a particular range for example

Pick Balance

From .00
To .99

Will select accounts with balance under \$1.

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Statements

This program prints warrants on warrant forms which may be served by your constable to pursue delinquent accounts.

How to Print Warrants

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you for this information is used to fill out warrant forms.

Warrant Fee

Type the amount of the warrant fee.

Marshal Fee

If you levy an additional Marshal fee, type it here. Amount over \$1 will be printed on the warrant as specified, amounts .99 or less will be treated as a percentage and multiplied time the total outstanding to create a Marshal's fee.

Lien Fee

County
Town

Type the name of the county and town as you want them to appear on the warrant and lien forms.

This
Day of
A.D.
Section

Type the information for the date appearing on the forms and the section number of the statutes that give you the authority to collect these fees.

Frequently asked Questions

How do I get the computer to demand warrant fees?

Printing a warrant form does not serve the warrant.
To indicate a warrant has been served use the Update, Accounts to Check the Warr box. Accounts with the box checked will demand a warrant fee when the account is accessed for payment.

I am asking for an individual warrant and noting is printing.

The computer will not print warrants whose tax due is zero.

How do print my signature on the form?

Create a .jpg file of your signature about 180 high x 680 wide.
Place it in your working foldered as ser-sig.jpg.

Refunds

Use this program to print refund notices or letters.
This program prints forms for all eligible account which
you can choose to actually issue or not.

How to Print Refund Notices

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask:

Type

Every Kind
Water
Sewer
A Assmt
B Assmt

Select the kind of bill you wish to print.

Order

1 Hookup
2 Name

...

Pick the order of the printed forms.

Print What

Notice
Letter
Both

The notice is the form you submit to get authorization to
issue the refund, The Letter is a letter to to the taxpayer
to accompany the check. An Action Notice has an action
taken section at the bottom.

Pick List

☒ Pick By Hookup?
From 100001
To 100002

If you wish to pick accounts by their hookup numbers check this
box and and specify the range.

Pick the type of forms you with to print.

Pick Minimum Credit

Type the smallest amount you wish to select for printing.

☐ Pick Action Notice

Check this box if you would like an Action Taken section to
appear at the bottom of the refund notice.

Signature Line 1
Signature Line 2

Type the label you wish to print under the signature lines
on your refund form. For example G. SMITH, COLLECTOR.

Comment

Type the text you would like to print in the Reason/Comment
section of the form. You can leave this blank and write the
reason on each individual form.

Account	Description
Water	
Sewer	
Assmt A	
Assmt B	
Inter/Lien	
Cash	

Type the account and account description you want to have printed on your refund form. If you do not use an account class in your town, leave it blank and it will not print on the form.

Interest Statements

Use this program to print interest statements or a report shown taxes and interest paid.

Statement and Report Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you:

Format

Statement
Report

Pick Statement to print individual cut sheets to mail ratepayers or Report to print a list you can use for reference.

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the report order you want.

Statement Covers

Start Payment Date
End Payment Date

Specify the payment date range you wish to see presented on the statements. For example to report all interest paid during 2002 Specify

Statement Covers

Start Payment Date 01/01/2002
End Payment Date 12/31/2002

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Lien

Use this program to add a lien fee to a range of accounts, and to print liens for individual bill or original assessments or to print lien releases.

Lien Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will let you specify:

Format

- 1 1 Lien /Page
- 2 2 Liens /Page
- 3 Lien+Release/Page
- 7 Lien/Page+Release/Page
- 8 Release for Liens Printed
- 5 Lien List

Pick the kind of form you wish to print.

What Type

- Water
- Sewer
- A Assmt
- B Assmt
- 1 Full A Assmt
- 2 Full B Assmt

Pick the type of bill to wish to add the fee to. Pick 1 or. 2 to print original full liens for the assessment.

What Bills

From 10/01/1999
To 10/01/1999

If you are liening one bill type the date of the bill in both the From and To dates as shown above. If you are issuing one line to cover a group of bills specify the date range for example.

What Bills

From 01/01/2002
To 07/01/2002

If you lien a range of bills the lien fee is placed on every bill in the range or just on the the most recent bill depending on how you specify the next option.

Assessments Bills

From 10/01/2004
To 10/31/2004

If you are liening original assessments type the date of the original assessment From and To dates. The above example liens assessment placed during October 2004.

Lien How

- Each Bill
- Combine Onto One

Pick Each Bill to print a lien for for each bill. Pick Combine Onto One to print one lien for each hookup. If you are issuing individual quarterly or half year bills, you should lien each bill. If you are issuing one bill payable in two INSTALLMENTS you would print just one lien.

Lien Fee

☐ Add Fee
Lien Fee\$

Check this box and specify the fee wish to have the computer add.

Skip Liens Fee

☐ Skip Small Liens
Under

Check this box and specify the amount of the smallest lien you wish to print if you wish to skip the printing and lienning of bill with small outstanding amounts.

Sequence Lien

☐ Sequence Liens
Volm
Page

Check this box and specify a starting Vol Page if you want the computer to print the volume page on the form.

Lien Text

The computer needs the following text to complete the lien form:

Fee Dates

Due Date 09/01/2002
Covers From 09/01/2002
Covers To 08/31/2002

This example is for a bill dated 09/01/2002 covering the the year ending the day before, with the lien printed on 10/01/2002 and filed on Oct 1 2002 at 4pm.

Lien Dates

Lien Date 10/01/2002
Record Date Oct 1 2002 at 4pm
Dated At Town of Sample this 11th day of May 2000

Type dates you wish to have appear on the lien form.

Lien Text

Town/Agency City of Angles
Collector John Smith
County Hartford
Type of Tax Sewer Use Tax

Type the name of the person and agency placing the lien for example Joe Smith, WPCA of Avon, Hartford in Collector,Town and County Respectively.

- ☐ Print 'Received for Record'?
☐ Print Collector's signature line on release?

Check these boxes if you want the 'Record' text and signature line printed on the receipts.

Release Options

Format

4 1 /Page
6 List

Pick the kind of form you wish to print.

What Type

Water
Sewer
A Assmt
B Assmt

- 1 Full A Assmt
- 2 Full B Assmt

Pick the type of bill to wish to add the fee to. Pick 1 or.
2 to print original full liens for the assessment.

Release How

Each Bill
Combine Onto One

Release in the same manner as you liened.

Dated
From 01/01/2008
To 01/01/2009

Specify specify the range of pay dates. For example to print release for all bill previously liened that were paid during 2008 type 01/01/2008 to 12/31/2008.

Sequence Releases

☐ Sequence Liens
Volm
Page

Check this box and specify a starting Vol Page if you want the computer to print the volume page on the form.

Town Clerk File

The computer produces a ASCII text file called SERLIENS.txt and a n XML file called IDLienYYYYMMDD.xml containing the liens or releases which you can give your Town Clerk so they can record the liens electronically.

This is the format of the text file produced is

Item		Size	Contents
INST	chr	6	"0000000
VOL	chr	5	Volume
PAGE	chr	4	Page
RDATE	chr	10	Record Date MMDDYYYY
KIND1	chr	8	Water Bills/Sewer Bills/Assmt Bills
KIND2	chr	8	Lien/Release
ASSR	chr	1	N
MAP	chr	10	Map-Block-Lot
LOCN	chr	27	Time and Location
LOCN2	chr	27	blank
TAX	num	7	00000000
GRANT	chr	1	"1
TOWN	chr	30	Your town's name
TOWN2	chr	30	blank
FIRM	chr	1	blank
VERIFY	chr	1	"V
RETURN	chr	25	blank
FILL	chr	55	blank

Frequently Asked Questions

I lost the lien forms I printed, how can I print them again with our adding an addition fee.

Run the program and uncheck the Add Fee check box.

Why is the name appearing on the lien release is not the name on file in Update, Hookups?

When you lien a hookup and print a lien, the computer stores the owner. It prints the same owner on the lien release. You can access the liened owner in Update, Hookup suing Edit, Lien Name.

How do print my signature on Lien and Shutoff Notice?.

Create a .jpg file of your signature about 180 high x 680 wide. Place it in your working foldered as ser-sig.jpg.

Release

Use this program to add a lien fee to a range of accounts, and to print liens for individual bill or original assessments or to print lien releases.

Lien Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will let you specify:

Format

- 1 1 Lien /Page
- 2 2 Liens /Page
- 3 Lien+Release/Page
- 7 Lien/Page+Release/Page
- 8 Release for Liens Printed
- 5 Lien List

Pick the kind of form you wish to print.

What Type

- Water
- Sewer
- A Assmt
- B Assmt
- 1 Full A Assmt
- 2 Full B Assmt

Pick the type of bill to wish to add the fee to. Pick 1 or. 2 to print original full liens for the assessment.

What Bills

From 10/01/1999
To 10/01/1999

If you are liening one bill type the date of the bill in both the From and To dates as shown above. If you are issuing one line to cover a group of bills specify the date range for example.

What Bills

From 01/01/2002
To 07/01/2002

If you lien a range of bills the lien fee is placed on every bill in the range or just on the the most recent bill depending on how you specify the next option.

Assessments Bills

From 10/01/2004
To 10/31/2004

If you are liening original assessments type the date of the original assessment From and To dates. The above example liens assessment placed during October 2004.

Lien How

- Each Bill
- Combine Onto One

Pick Each Bill to print a lien for for each bill. Pick Combine Onto One to print one lien for each hookup. If you are issuing individual quarterly or half year bills, you should lien each bill. If you are issuing one bill payable in two INSTALLMENTS you would print just one lien.

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☐ Add Fee
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Check this box and specify the fee wish to have the computer add.

Skip Liens Fee

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Check this box and specify the amount of the smallest lien you wish to print if you wish to skip the printing and lienning of bill with small outstanding amounts.

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Page

Check this box and specify a starting Vol Page if you want the computer to print the volume page on the form.

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The computer needs the following text to complete the lien form:

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Lien Dates

Lien Date 10/01/2002
Record Date Oct 1 2002 at 4pm
Dated At Town of Sample this 11th day of May 2000

Type dates you wish to have appear on the lien form.

Lien Text

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Collector John Smith
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Type of Tax Sewer Use Tax

Type the name of the person and agency placing the lien for example Joe Smith, WPCA of Avon, Hartford in Collector,Town and County Respectively.

- ☐ Print 'Received for Record'?
- ☐ Print Collector's signature line on release?

Check these boxes if you want the 'Record' text and signature line printed on the receipts.

Release Options

Format

4 1 /Page
6 List

Pick the kind of form you wish to print.

What Type

Water
Sewer
A Assmt
B Assmt

- 1 Full A Assmt
- 2 Full B Assmt

Pick the type of bill to wish to add the fee to. Pick 1 or.
2 to print original full liens for the assessment.

Release How

Each Bill
Combine Onto One

Release in the same manner as you liened.

Dated
From 01/01/2008
To 01/01/2009

Specify specify the range of pay dates. For example to print
release for all bill previously liened that were paid during
2008 type 01/01/2008 to 12/31/2008.

Sequence Releases

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Page

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KIND1	chr	8	Water Bills/Sewer Bills/Assmt Bills
KIND2	chr	8	Lien/Release
ASSR	chr	1	N
MAP	chr	10	Map-Block-Lot
LOCN	chr	27	Time and Location
LOCN2	chr	27	blank
TAX	num	7	00000000
GRANT	chr	1	"1
TOWN	chr	30	Your town's name
TOWN2	chr	30	blank
FIRM	chr	1	blank
VERIFY	chr	1	"V
RETURN	chr	25	blank
FILL	chr	55	blank

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Why is the name appearing on the lien release is not the name on file in Update, Hookups?

When you lien a hookup and print a lien, the computer stores the owner. It prints the same owner on the lien release. You can access the liened owner in Update, Hookup suing Edit, Lien Name.

How do print my signature on Lien and Shutoff Notice?.

Create a .jpg file of your signature about 180 high x 680 wide. Place it in your working foldered as ser-sig.jpg.

Import Usage

Use this program to update your accounts with the MDC usage information. It applies the usage from comma separated value file you prepare from the MDC files.

How Apply the Readings

The computer will ask you to confirm that you have read the tapes onto your disk and built the MDC/METER number index:

Update Options

☐ Update Use Unit? 6.

If you wish to update one of your use units, check this box and specify the code for the unit you wish to update. If you uncheck this box this program will print the report, but not update any unit.

[*] Apply Factors to Usage

Q1 1.00

Q2 .90

Q3 .90

Q4 1.00

Check this box and specify factors for e quarters if you wish to modify the readings you are importing by a factor.

[*] Store Reading

From Bill Date 11/01/2004

Check this box and specify a bill date to record the readings you are importing on the readings data for the bill date you specify.

Print Options

☐ Skip Ok messages on report?

Check this box to limit the report to printing errors.

Compare Options

☐ Compare New Use against Unit? 6.

Print percent LOWER than 10

Print percent HIGHER than 120

Check this box and specify a unit now on file, to have the computer compare the usage on file (last years) the new usage (in the MDC file) and print a message if the percentage change is over the highest or under the lowest you specify. In the example above hookups with new usage 120% greater than last year and hookup with usage 20% of last year or lower will print.

The Files This Program Reads

This program reads two comma separated value (.csv) file named MONTHLY.CSV and QUARTERLY.CSV. The MONTHLY file containing data in the following order

Meter	The Key - Called customer by the MDC starts with 7
Date	Date of Reading in YYYYMMDD format
R	Reading

The Data in the files must be sorted by Meter then Date.

How To Prepare The CSV Files

Here is how to create the .csv file this program reads.

1. Opening the files the MDC send you.
2. Rearrange the columns to match the order specified above, you can leave any other unneeded columns in the file if they follow the required columns above.
3. Edit, Format all number columns to be Number .00 without (,) comma separation.
4. Edit the Date to Be Custom YYYYMMDD
5. File, Save As and save the file as a Comma Separated Value file. Using the Name QUARTERLY or MONTHLY

Frequently Asked Questions

I updated my unit last week. Now when I as it to compare why does noting print?

The comparison is between the new reading in the MDC file and the usage in your file on the hookups. If you updated the hookups the amount in your file and in the MDC file is the same.

Import Usage

Use this program to update your accounts with the Connecticut Water Company usage information. It applies the usage from a flat ASCII file you received called CONWAT.DAT

How Apply the Readings

Start by placing the CONWAT.DAT file in your working folder.

Update Options

☐ Update Use Unit? GL

If you wish to update one of your use units, check this box and specify the code for the unit you wish to update. If you uncheck this box this program will print the report, but not update any unit.

[*] Apply Factors to Usage

Q1 1.00

Q2 .90

Q3 .90

Q4 1.00

Check this box and specify factors for e quarters if you wish to modify the readings you are importing by a factor.

[*] Store Reading

From Bill Date 07/01/2006

Check this box and specify a bill date to record the readings you are importing on the readings data for the bill date you specify.

Neptune Guns

Use this program to write the file to load the Neptune guns.

Import File From Guns

A meter reading is attached to all hookups which have the meter number. One record returned from the guns may be attached to one or more hookups with the same meter number.

File to Export

NEPTUNE.DAT

Type the filename you wish to create.

Read is for Bill Date

Date

Type the date for the reading.

Export What

All

Missing Readings

Pick Missing reading to export only hookups who have no reading for the bill date you specified above.

Pick by Route

☐ Pick by Route

From

To

Check this box and specify the route limits if you wish to limit the export file.

Neptune Guns

Use this program to read the file the guns return and apply readings to your hookups.

Import Neptune Gun File

A meter reading is attached to all hookups which have the meter number. One record returned from the guns may be attached to one or more hookups with the same meter number.

File to Export

NEPTUNE.DAT

Type the filename you wish to import

Read is for Bill Date

Date

Type the date for the reading.

Update Readings

Use this program to update reading.

You can use this program to type readings, if you do not import the readings from a file or meter guns.

Update Readings

Use the record locator, VCR buttons or View menu item to locate hookups you wish to change. See the Update Hookup section for example on how to locate records.

Reading

Type the reading.

Reading Date

Type the date the reading was taken. This is for your reference only, so if you have no need to record the reading date use the bill date.

Bill Date

Type the date of the bill for which you are entering the reading.

Type

Indicate if you are typing a Reading that will be used to compute consumption by subtracting it from a prior reading or Use that will be used as you type it.

When typing a series of readings, you can fill-in all of the items for the first reading, and then change just the reading and possibly the reading date to enter other readings.

Readings Work List

Use this program to print readings.

How to Print Readings

Format

Full
Totals Only

Specify to see each reading printed, specify Totals only to print just the final total page.

Order

Hookup
Location
...

Pick the order you want the readings printed.

Pick Date

☐ Pick Reading Date?
From 11/01/2003
To 11/01/2005

If you wish to limit the readings printed to those that fall within a range of dates, check this box and specify the range. In the example above reading dated from November 1 2003 to November 1 2005 will be printed.

Pick by Reader

☐ Pick Reader?
Reader XX

To limit the report to readings take by a specific reader, check this box and specify the reader.

Pick Readings

☐ Pick Readings Amounts?
From 500000.00
To 1000000.00

If you wish to limit the readings printed to those that fall in a range of value, check this box and specify the range. In the example above reading from one-half million to one million will be printed.

Missing/NoMove Readings

Use this program to print missing, and zero readings and zero consumption (non advancing meters) for a particular reading date.

How to Locate Odd Readings

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you:

Format

Full
Abbreviated

Pick full to print the taxpayers name and address, pick abbreviated to print just the property and meter description.

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the report order you want.

Pick by Reader

☐ Pick Reader?
Reader

Check this box and specify the reader if you wish to limit the report to a particular reader.

Check Reading

Date 01/01/2004

The computer will print a list of accounts which have no reading or a zero reading or a stuck for this reading date.

Only hookups which have a meter size are include on the report

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Consumption Change List

Use this program to examine consumptions. You can pick readings for two date and pick odd reading by a percentage deviation.

Report Options

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you:

Format

Abbreviated
Full

Order

1 List
2 Name
3 Location
4 Map
5 Route
6 Meter

Pick the format of the book and the print order. A full book will print each taxpayers name, location, map and meter in the range you specified, even if the selection criteria below is not met. An Abbreviated book will only print an account if the selection below are met.

Pick Billing Dates

Match Date: 12/01/1999
To Date: 12/01/1998

Type the two date you wish to compare. The above example will compare consumption for the bill date 12/01/1999 to the bill issued a year earlier on 12/01/1998.

Pick Meter Size

☐ Pick Size
Size

Check this box and specify the size of the meter if you wish to limit this report to only one meter size.

Pick Increases

☒ Pick Increases?
Bigger than %: .75
Bigger than #: 20

Pick Decreases

☒ Pick Decreases?
Smaller than %: .75
Smaller than #: 20

Type the range of deviations you wish to pick. The above will print accounts with reading 75% or less then the prior reading or 75% or more then the prior reading and which have increase in consumption greater than 20 or a decrease in consumption smaller than -20.

Pick Increases -----
Pick Increases? Yes
Bigger than %: 1.00
Bigger than #: 0

Pick Decreases -----

Pick Decreases? Nos
Smaller than %: .00
Smaller than #: 0

Will print accounts with readings 100% bigger than the prior reading.

Frequently Asked Questions

How do I print a book of accounts with no readings on August 1, 1995.

Ask for a Full Book, and specify the pick dates as 08/01/1995. Accounts with no readings on August 1, 1995 will show (with no readings) in the book along with the accounts with readings.

I have asked for decreases below 25 percent like this

Pick Decreases -----
Pick Decreases? Yes
Smaller than : .25

and I get reading showing 10%, 15% increases, why?

You have asked for reading which are below 25 of what they were last time. To ask for reading which are less and 25% LESS specify:

Pick Decreases -----
Pick Decreases? Yes
Smaller than : -.25

This may help:

-.25	-.10	-.05	0	.05	.10	.25
.....						
<-----X			less than -.05			
<-----X			less than .05			

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Meter List

Use this program to print a work list of meters.

How to The Rerpot

Format

Full
Abbreviated
Label/PostCards

Pick Abbreviated to show the meter, date and location information. Pick Full to show the taxpayers address as well. Pick Lables to print labels or postcards.

Order 1

Meter
Route
Size
Last Chgd Date
Next Chgd Date
Inspect Date
Test Date

Pick the report order. You can specify a primary and secondary sort orders by specifying an Order1 and Order2.

Pick By Group

☐ Pick Group?
Group

Pick By Reader

☐ Pick Reader?
Reader

If you wish to limit the report to a specify reader if group, specify it here.

Pick Last Change

☐ Pick Last Change
Form
To

Pick Next Change

☐ Pick Next Change
From
To

If you wish to limit the report to meters having particular Last Change or Next Change date specify them here.

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Frequently Asked Questions

The totals by meter at the end of the report has an entry for ??, what is this?

The ?? is the count of meter with a meter number but no meter size.

Move Readings

Use this program to change the date of readings. If you mistakenly assign reading to an incorrect bill date you can use this program to reassign the reading.

How to Change a Reading Date

To permanently change the date a reading applies to, pick this program on the menu and supply the old and new bill dates:

Change Readings

From Date 10/15/2005
To Date 12/01/2005

This will change readings that now apply to a 10/15/2005 billing to apply to a 12/01/2005 billing.

Billing Totals

Use this program to print billing totals.
Report Options

Type

Water Use

Sewer Use

Pick the type of bill you wish summarize.

Pick Billing

Date

Specify the date of the billing you wish to see on the report.

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Consumption Totals

Use this program to print consumption totals.
Report Options

Type

Water Use

Sewer Use

Pick the type of bill you wish summarize.

Pick Readings

Date

Specify the date of the reading (billing) you wish to see on the report.

Range Select

See the Rate Book section of this guide for an example of how to use the items on the range select tab to further limit the hookups you see on the report.

Compare Billings

Use this program to compare two billing. You can use it to locate unusually large increase or decreases in bills.

How to Compare Bills

Pick the program on the menu and the computer will ask:

Type

Water Use
Sewer Use
Assessment

Pick the type of bill and group you wish to work with.

Compare Bills

Date1
Date2

Type the dates of the bills you wish to compare.

Pick Over

☒ Pick Over?
By Factor:..10

Pick Under

☒ Pick Under?
By Factor:..25

Indicate if you wish to pick differences where the Date2 bill is over (greater than) the Date1 bill, of Under (less than) the Date1 bill. The above example will print any Date2 bill which is greater then the Date1 by 10% or less than the Date1 bill by 25%.

Project Assessment Bill

Use this program to print a report showing the amount of the installment you plan to bill in future years.

Delq Interest Accrued

Top Ratepayers

Use this program to print a list of the top ratepayers.

Report Options

Type

Usage
Water Only
Sewer Only
Just Assessment
A Assmt Only
B Assmt

Pick the type of bills you wish to use for balances that print in the report.

Pick Bills

Form
To

Specify the range of bill date you want summed for the report
Type the date you wish to compute interest through.

Pick Group

Check this box and specify the group to select a particular group.

Print How Many Rate Payers

Specify the number of ratepayer you want to see on the report. For example specifying 10 will print the top 10 ratepayers.

Upload Data.

Use this program to upload your data to the internet for public access.

How to Operate

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask

Upload
Remove

Select upload to send your data to the internet. Pick remove to remove the data.

To access the data use the link

www.mytaxbill.info/cgi

where XX are your town's initials.

This program will not upload account you have marked by checking the Hide? check box.

Condense

Use this program to condense your data files.

As you work with your assessment files they become disorganized. Condensing squeezes extra space out of your they take up less room on the disk. Condensing also makes it easier for the computer to find accounts and will make your computer run faster.

You should Condense as often as you can; We recommend at least once a week. Making a Condense followed by a Verify you routine just before making a backup will give you clean tidy and proofed data on you backup.

How to Operate

This program rewrites your data files and must be done alone, with no one else using the tax assessment system.

The computer will ask you to identify which files you wish to work with:

What

All Files
Tables

How

Full
Quick

When

Now
Delayed

Pick All Files, Full and Now. You can delay the start of the index by picking Delayed, and specify an start time.

Processing Time

After you answer the questions, and click on Ok, the computer will condense your files. This may take some time depending on the size of your files and the speed of your computer.

Where Your Data is kept

Here are the names of the data files where the computer stores the utility billing information.

UTLXXA	Control Information
UTLXXB	Hookups
UTLXXC	Bills and Payments
UTLXXD	Bills and Payments
UTLXXE	Rates
UTLXXF	Changes
UTLXXG	Readings
UTLXXH	Notes

Data files end in .txt the associated indices which are rebuilt by the condense end in .isi, .is2, etc, and .aim.

The XX in the above file is the first two letters of the ID you use to logon.

Frequently Asked Questions

The computer seem to be taking no time at all to do the condense, is something wrong?

Could be. Your work stations memory could be too small, your network logon could be lacking the permission needed to delete and rewrite the files, or your data could be in such bad shape that the computer cannot complete the Condense.

If you can Verify after the Condense, proceed with your work, and drop us a note voicing your concern.

Verify

Use this program to have the computer check to see if all of your utility data is in good shape.

If you experience a computer hardware problem, such as a power outage, your computer may damage your data.

Run this program to prove to yourself that the data is undamaged.

How to Operate

The computer will try to read all of your data. If it finds an error you will want to restore your data from your last good backup before you proceed.

What Files

All File
Hookups
Payments
Readings

Pick All files.

What Kind

Verify

Pick Verify. Upon your request, to repair or modify your data we will add to this list.

Backup Data

You must take action to secure your data from natural and man-made disasters. This program permits you to make a duplicate copy of your data either Inside the computer on your hard disk or Outside on a usb thumb drive or other media.

It is necessary to make periodic backups of your data which can be removed from the vicinity of your computer and stored in a secure location. Remember fire, flood, theft or another event could render your computer inoperative at any time.

How to Backup Your Data

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you for the destination of the backup

- Inside on Disk
- Outside On Diskettes
- Drive Letter
- Specify File Name
- Web Browser Upload
- Copy to
- Upload to Andi Site

Pick Inside on Disk and the computer will make a duplicate of your data inside the computer on the disk.

Pick Drive Letter and specify the letter of the storage you want to use to store your data. For example if you have a USB thumb drive inserted in G:, pick this option, and specify G.

Pick Copy to and specify a drive letter and the program will copy the files, rather than compress the files, onto the drive you specified.

Pick Upload to Andi Site to send a copy of your data to ftp.aldenovakdodd.com. If you would like to send us a copy but your firewall prevents access, you can make an Inside backup and send it to us by attaching it to an email or using Tools, Upload File on your menu by picking Attach to Email.

☐ Use secure sftp?

If you have a NAT router blocking the ftp conversation with our ftp site you can switch to using secure ftp. Before you can use this option you need to accept the our ftp server on each computer that you use. You tech my need to help you do this:

At a command prompt:

1. Jump into your working tax folder.
- 2 Type psftp www.my-tax-bill.info and push enter.
- 3 Respond Y to accept the server's id.

How to Backup Your Folder

If you picked Tool, My Folder Backup to start the backup, you backing up your entire folder and fewer destination options will appear.

Frequently Asked Questions

What exactly am I backing up?

If you picked File, Backup on the menu you are making a copy

of the data associated with the system you are using. That is, if you are logged on the '12 Tax Assessment system you are backing up the '12 tax assessment data files.

If you picked Tool, My Folder, Backup on the menu you are making a copy of the folder that contains you data, the programs and everything else in your working folder.

How Many Inside backups does my computer keep?

Backups are added to the disk drive you specify. So it will put as many as can fit on the disk.

I just updated my comptuer to a new opearting system and the backup stopped working. How to I fix this?

You new system likley requires the 33 bit version of the backup. Pick File, use 32 Bit arj on the Backup menu.

Restore Data

Should you experience a disaster you may need to restore from a backup copy of your data to get the computer operating again. This program lets you make active the data you previously backed up.

How Restore Your Data

The computer will give you the option of restoring data from a backup you made.

- Inside on Disk
- Outside On Diskettes
- Drive Letter
- Specify File Name
- Web Browser Upload
- Upload to Andi Site
- List Inside Backups

Inside Restore

Pick Inside to have the computer make one of your inside backup copies of your data active. The computer will look back through the inside backup set you and and offer you them one at a time starting with the most recent.

I will restore from the INSIDE backup dates 01/01/2001?

Click on Ok if you wish to use the backup you made on this date. If you click on Cancel the computer will offer you the next oldest backup.

If it can open the backup the computer will show you the files it contains and ask

Proceed with restore of these files.

Click on Ok if you wish to restore the files.

Outside Restore

If you pick outside the computer will prompt you to insert your backup set of diskettes starting with diskette #1:

Insert Backup Diskette #1

Put the first diskette of your backup set into the a: drive and click on Ok. When the computer has read the information from #1 it will ask you for the next diskette. After you have worked your way through the set the computer will copy the data to you active tax folder and make it active.

List Inside Backups

Pick List Inside Backups to have the computer print a list of all the backups you have on file and their contents.

Condense!

After you restore the data it is necessary to Pick File, Condense to rebuild all of the associated index files. It is also wise to Verify your data to be sure the data you expect made it back into the computer.

Frequently asked question

Exactly what am I restoring?

The inside and outside backup sets contain just the data associated with the system you used to create them. If you were logged on to your 2003 Tax Assessment system when you made the backup, it contains the data from the 2003 system.

What if I make more than one backup on a day?

The backups are dated on the day you create them. Each new diskette set contains a new picture of all of your data at the time you create the backup. If you initiate multiple inside backups from the same system, the most recent overwrites the data done earlier in the day. If you make backups of the same system from multiple years, all of the years are added to the same backup.

What if I make more than one backup on a day?

The computer places each system, Assessment, Collection, Budget, etc. in separate inside archives.

Export to Ratepayer

Use this program to create an export a file that you can give away or import onto a spread sheet.

How to Operate

Pick the type of date you wish to export.

What Data

Hookups
Groups
Readngs
Bills+Payments

Pick the data you wish to export.

Type of File

ASCII Flat File
Comma Delimited
Quote & Comma Delimited
XML

Pick the format of file you wish to export. Comma delimited files can be opened by a wide range of computer tools.

☐ Do not export hookup checked 'Hide?'

Check this box to have the computer exclude from the file hookups where you have checked the Hide? check box.

File

The file will be laced in your wokring folder and called UBXX-T.ttt where XX are you towns initials, the frist two letters of your login, the T is the First letter of WHat Date you specified, and ttt is txt, dlq, csv, or xml to correspond to the Type of FIlle you specified.

The description of the data items is contained in the header of .dlq, .csv and in each item label in the xml file.

Size	Position	Description
2	1	Not Used
6	3	List Number
32	9	Ratepayer Name
30	41	Name 2
30	71	Address 1
30	101	Address 2
25	131	City/St
10	156	Zipcode
14	166	Tax ID
17	180	Telephone
3	197	Empty
20	200	Account
32	220	Location of Property
17	252	Map
32	269	Description
32	321	Note
10	333	Vol Page
2	343	Sewer Group
2	345	Water Group
2	347	Assmt Group A
2	349	Assmt Group B
1	351	Y/N Installment A Override
1	352	Y/N Installment B Override
1	353	Y/N Payments A Override

1	354	Y/N Payments B Override
1	355	Bank Code / MDC Reimburse code
1	356	Y/N Account is hidden
8	357	Perminate ID
14	365	Meter Number
14	379	Meter Serial
12	383	Meter Reading Route
2	395	Meter Size
6	407	Meter Last Changed Date
6	403	Meter Next Changed Date
1	409	Meter Location
1	410	Gallons/CCF
6	411	Meter Installed
6	417	Meter Tested
1	421	Digits Read
4	423	Reader Notes
1	427	Read Way
2	423	Reader ID
1	421	Y/N STOP SENDING BILLS
1	422	Y/N Payment Plan
1	423	Y/N
1	424	Y/N LIEN
1	425	Y/N ADDRESS LOCK
1	426	Y/N TAXABLE
1	427	
1	428	
1	429	
6	430	Units
7.2	446	Assessment 1
7.2	455	Installment 1
7.2	464	Paid to Date 1
8	529	Change Date
1	537	Change Action
2	538	Change Action
2[10]	540	Water Rate Cats
6.2[10]	560	Units
2[10]	650	Sewer Rate Cats
6.2[10]	670-760	Units
2[10]	761	Assessment 1 Rate Cats
6.2[10]	781-870	Units
2[10]	871	Assessment 2 Rate Cats
6.2[10]	891-980	Units
7.2	981	Assessment 2
7.2	991	Installment 2
7.2	1001	Paid to Date 2

Export to Coll Agency

Use this program to create a file for a collection agency.

How to Create the File

Specify the hookups you wish to include in the file.

Collection Agency File Format

This is the format of the file.

Name

Specify the file name to contain the data.

☐ Comma delimited

Check this box and file will contain the data items listed below seperated by comma and delimited by quotes.

Description	Type	Size	
YEAR	Char	4	
TYPE	Char	1	
LIST	Char	7	
DUE DATE	Char	6	YYMMDD
NAME	Char	30	
NAME	Char	30	
ADDRESS1	Char	30	
ADDRESS2	Char	30	
CITY	Char	22	
ZIP	Char	10	
MAKE	Char	8	
MODEL	Char	8	
YR	Char	2	
TAG	Char	8	
VID	Char	17	
LOCATION	Char	35	
TAX	Numb	11	
INTEREST	Numb	11	
CODE	Char	2	
XREF	Char	20	
MAIL	Char	1	
PHONE	Char	10	
DOB	Char	6	
NOTE	Char	33	
STATUS	Char	1	
OVERDUE DATE	Char	6	YYMMDD

Zipcode Update

Use this program to extract a file to send to the post office service bureau for address and zip code updates and to import the file they return to you.

How to Operate

The computer will ask you

What

Export File To Send Out
Import File Returned

Pick Export File To Send Out to create the data file to send the service bureau or to create a file you will process with zip+4 software. The computer will print a file layout for the file it creates.

Pick Import File Returned and the computer will update your data file with the zip code the service bureau sent back.

Purge

Use this program to permanently remove bills from the computer. The computer will look for the bills you specify and remove all record of the bills and its payments.

If your computer has enough storage you may never need to run this program. You may only need to run this when an group is fully paid or after you have accumulated more than 15 years of bills.

You may wish to print a Rate Book for the bills you are deleting so you have a final record of your collections.

You can also use this program to remove bills you created by mistake.

How to Purge Bills

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask:

What Dates

From 10/01/1999
To 06/01/2000

Type the date of the bills you wish to delete. The above example will look at bills dated 10/01/1999 through 06/01/2000 and decide if they are to be deleted by the sum of their balances.

What Type

Usage
Water Only
Sewer Only
A Assmt
B Assmt

Pick the type of bill you wish to delete.

What Balance

Fully Paid
Credits & Paid
Any Balance

Pick Full Pick to delete bill with zero balances, pick Credits to delete bills with a zero or credit balance, or pick Any Balance to delete all bills.

Pick by Group

☒ Pick Group?
Group: 10

Pick by Hookup

☒ Pick Hookup?
From 100000
To 100100

If you wish to work on a particular group or range of hookups specify it here. The above example will only look at account 100000 to 100100 in group 10.

Frequently Asked Questions

Some of my hookups have two bills which each have a balance, but together they total zero. Will these be deleted.

Yes, If both bills are included in the bill date range

you specify.

If I specify just one bill, such as 01/01/2002 and Fully Paid
If there is a 01/01/2003 bill with a balance will the 01/01/2002
be purged if it is zero.

Yes, the computer only totals the bills in the date range you
specify.

Purge

Use this program to purge readings or CofC's. You can use it to remove data after they get too old to be useful or to remove data you applied in error on a particular date.

How to Purge Old Data

Specify the date range for the data you wish to remove:

Purge

From Date 01/01/2004
To Date 12/31/2004

This will remove any data dated during 2004.

Pick Group

☐ Pick by Group?
Group

Pick Hookup

☐ Pick by Hookup?
From
To

You can limit the bill you select to purge to a specific group and/or a specific range of hookups.

How to Purge a Reading Mistake

To delete a readings you applied in error, supply the date: you wish to remove:

Purge Readings

From Date 04/01/2004
To Date 04/01/2004

This will remove the readings dated 04/01/2004.

Purging CofC's with Blank Notes

☐ Only Purge if Note is Blank?

Check this box if you are purging CofC's and only wish to purge CofC if the CofC Note is blank.

Preview

You can capture reports the computer produces into a file which you can later view or print.

How to Capture a Report

To have the computer capture a report to a file so you can view it later, before you click on the final Ok, push the F6 key. You will notice that the capture button on the tool bar is depressed. The computer will place the report into a file called REPT-XX.prt where XX are your initials from the logon you used.

You can view the captured report from the menu by pushing F7, the preview button, by picking File, Preview.

If you prefer to specify a name for the captured report, before you click the final OK in a report, push the capture button on the tool bar or pick Report Capture, from the menu. The computer will show you a Save As dialog and permit you specify the file name. Specify a file name with .prt at the end.

How to Capture a Delimited File

Before you click the final OK in a report, push the capture button on the tool bar. The computer will show you a Save As dialog and permit you specify the file name. Specify a file name with .dlm at the end to get a comma delimited file or .dlq at then end to get a comma and quote delimited file.

The computer decides what kin of file you want based on the last part of the name you specify.

Text Formats (Reports)	
.dlm	Comma Delimited
.dlq	Comma & Quote Delimited
.prt	Report File
Graphic Formats (Report or Forms)	
.ps	Post Script
.pdf	Adobe pdf

How to View a Captured Report

You can view reports on the computer's display before you print them on paper. To View a Captured Report Pick File, Preview on the main menu, or push the Preview button on the toolbar.

The computer will show you the default report you captured. That is the report call REPT-XX.prt where XX are the initial from your logon.

You can open any text captured file for previewing using the File, Open action in the preview menu. So if you save a report in c:\temp call myreport.prt use File, Open to specify c:\temp\myreport.prt

The Capture program permits you to view the report and print it if you wish. Use the VCR buttons or the menu to navigate the the report file.

You can overlay a form, such as a letterhead onto the report.
Pick file, Overlay Form and pick a .tif file.

Forms Cannot be Captured

Reports and forms which use windows to paint multiple fonts and lines on the page cannot be captured as a text file and viewed. If you try to capture a form as a text file the computer will tell you it cannot be done.

You can, however capture a form to a .pdf file and use Adobe's pdf viewer to view and manipulate the file.

Print Sizes

There are three print sizes available. Tiny, Compressed and Regular. Regular is 10 Cpi and will print a report on the wide green bar paper. Compresses will print the on a 8 1/2 x 11" landscape page of paper. and Tiny will fit it on portrait 8 1/2 x 11" sheet.

Pick a font form the Format menu or by pushing the font button on the toolbar or by pushing its shortcut key F8.

Locating Information on the Report

Pick Edit, Find to have the computer search the report for information.

Find
Find
Type string to find.

For example if you are looking for maps which contain the work REAR, type

Find REAR

The computer will scan the report and stop at the first Occurrence of the string REAR. The computer start looking form you position in the report and searches to the end.

The action is help in finding then you would normally would have to locate by reading through a printed report.

Print the Report

Pick File, Print and the computer will ask:

Print
Pages 1 to 9999
Copies 1

Specify the page ranges you wish to print, and the number of copies you want.

☐ Print raw to old printer?

Check the print raw to old printer if you wish to print the report on a old line printer.

Deleting A Captured Report

Pick File, Delete Report and the computer will delete the report and return you to the menu.

User Logons

Use this dialog to add new logon's or modify exsising logons.

How to Add a Logon

Pick Edit, Add form the menu and fillin these items. Click the green Check when you are done.

Logon

Type the logon you wish to use. Compose the logon in this form TTYANYTHING where TT are your town's initials, YY is the year of the data and ANYTHING is your name, your initials or a clerk designation. For Example to Add a logon for North Canaan's 2000/01 Budget System you would type NC01BUD, for Clerk MAY in Glastonbury's 2003 assessment system you would use GL03MAY.

YourName

Type the name of the person using the ID, or some other identification you need to identify this logon. You may leave this blank.

Password

You may leave this blank. If you type a password here you will need to type it as part of the logon.

Access

0 Unlimited
1 Update Clerk
2 Access Clerk

Unless you have a specific need to restrict this ID use 0 Unlimited. The 1 and 2 levels, make items disappear form the menu. For exaample Level 1 premits upadte accees woth out access to system function such Backup, Restore, Condense, and Verify. Level 2 provides only access to lookup data and print select reports.

System Menu

asr000 Assessment
asr001 Asst Public
clr000 Collection
clr001 Posting
clr010 Coll Public
ser000 Utility Bill
bur000 Budget
emr000 Payroll

Pick the system you wish the Id to take you to.

Printer

Leave this as set.

How to Add an Old Logon

You can add logons to Collection and Assessment systems older than 2000.

Pick Edit, Add Old Logons, and fill in the items as outlined above.

System Menu

ass000 Assessment
bud000 Budget
emp000 Payroll
clr002 Collection 97/98/99

My Folder

You must take action to secure your data from natural and man-made disasters. This program permits you to make a duplicate copy of your data either Inside the computer on your hard disk or Outside on a usb thumb drive or other media.

It is necessary to make periodic backups of your data which can be removed from the vicinity of your computer and stored in a secure location. Remember fire, flood, theft or another event could render your computer inoperative at any time.

How to Backup Your Data

Select the program on the menu and the computer will ask you for the destination of the backup

- Inside on Disk
- Outside On Diskettes
- Drive Letter
- Specify File Name
- Web Browser Upload
- Copy to
- Upload to Andi Site

Pick Inside on Disk and the computer will make a duplicate of your data inside the computer on the disk.

Pick Drive Letter and specify the letter of the storage you want to use to store your data. For example if you have a USB thumb drive inserted in G:, pick this option, and specify G.

Pick Copy to and specify a drive letter and the program will copy the files, rather than compress the files, onto the drive you specified.

Pick Upload to Andi Site to send a copy of your data to ftp.aldenovakdodd.com. If you would like to send us a copy but your firewall prevents access, you can make an Inside backup and send it to us by attaching it to an email or using Tools, Upload File on your menu by picking Attach to Email.

☐ Use secure spftp?

If you have a NAT router blocking the ftp conversation with our ftp site you can switch to using secure ftp. Before you can use this option you need to accept the our ftp server on each computer that you use. You tech my need to help you do this:

At a command prompt:

1. Jump into your working tax folder.
- 2 Type psftp www.my-tax-bill.info and push enter.
- 3 Respond Y to accept the server's id.

How to Backup Your Folder

If you picked Tool, My Folder Backup to start the backup, you backing up your entire folder and fewer destination options will appear.

Frequently Asked Questions

What exactly am I backing up?

If you picked File, Backup on the menu you are making a copy

of the data associated with the system you are using. That is, if you are logged on the '12 Tax Assessment system you are backing up the '12 tax assessment data files.

If you picked Tool, My Folder, Backup on the menu you are making a copy of the folder that contains you data, the programs and everything else in your working folder.

How Many Inside backups does my computer keep?

Backups are added to the disk drive you specify. So it will put as many as can fit on the disk.

I just updated my comptuer to a new opearting system and the backup stopped working. How to I fix this?

You new system likley requires the 33 bit version of the backup. Pick File, use 32 Bit arj on the Backup menu.

Install Software

Use this program to install software or data.

Pick Help, Install Software/Data on the menu and the computer will ask you to specify where the update is located.

Pick File
Get From Andi Site
CD Rom Update
Specify System
Web Browser Download
Arj32

Get From Andi Site

Pick Get From Website to get the update from our website. You will need an account with an internet service provider to access the internet.

Web Browser Download

If ftp access to the internet is blocked on your workstation you will not be able to use Get From Andi Site. This option opens your web browser on a web page you can use to download.

Specify System

Pick this option to download a software package other than the one you are logged on to.

Pick File

Pick Pick File if you know the location of the file you wish to install. For example the file may be on a CD ROM, or USB Drive.

Alternate Ways To Get An Update

If your town has your internet connection set improperly, you may receive a transmission error. Sometimes these errors are caused by momentary disturbances, and you can be successful if you try the download later.

If you get transmission errors repeatedly, you can use this procedure to get and install a software update:

1. Start your browser and point it at www.aldenovakdodd.com/downloads
2. Click on the link for the software for your system.
3. Save it to your desktop.
4. When the download completes drag the software and drop it on the &

View User Guide

You can print an entire User Guide, complete with index and appendices. Pick Help, Print User Guide on the main menu.

All of the information contained in the printed User Guide is available to you at the computer. Push the help button on a toolbar, or push its shortcut key key F1, to review the user guide related to the program you are using. You can print just the one section by pushing the print button on the Help Window's toolbar.

The help window will stay on the desk top until you close it, so you can refer to the guide to find the answer to your question while viewing the program you are using.

Passwords

The password for taking a special action, such as deleting or running a special action, such as a purge is

PR00F

About

Pick About on the Help menu to display information about the application software

Municipal Software

Frequently Asked Questions

I just installed software and nothing seemed to change.
How can I tell if I have the update?

Look at the Help, About. The date we modified the program is shown in the compile date.

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